



**METHODOLOGY FOR WRITING PAPERS AT THE FACULTY
OF BUSINESS OF KLAIPĖDOS VALSTYBINĖ KOLEGIJA |
HIGHER EDUCATION INSTITUTION**

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Preface

This is a methodological publication is intended for students and lecturers of the Faculty of Business of Klaipėdos valstybinė kolegija | Higher Education Institution. Its purpose is to help students prepare methodically orderly written work and to establish uniform requirements for the preparation and assessment of written student work. These methodological recommendations and established rules will help in proper preparation of papers, essays, reflections, reports, projects, articles, coursework, graduation papers for pedagogical studies, and graduation papers, as well as understand their specifics and structure. The instructions and requirements for students' written work specified in this methodology are mandatory. However, departments can take a creative approach in the application of this methodology taking into account the results and specifics of the study programmes they are implementing.

The compilers of the methodology did not seek to present an absolutely complete methodology for writing student papers. Students and their advisers need to apply the methodological innovations on their own, using the knowledge and skills acquired during lectures, especially in applied research methodology, marketing research, management, language culture, document management, information technology and other subjects.

1. GENERAL PROVISIONS FOR WRITING COURSE PAPERS, GPPS, AND GRADUATION PAPERS AT THE FACULTY OF BUSINESS

Students writing papers must comply with the academic integrity and other ethical requirements, specified in the documents of Klaipėdos valstybinė kolegija | Higher Education Institution, as provided for in the Code of Academic Ethics of Klaipėdos valstybinė kolegija | Higher Education Institution.

Throughout the course of studies, student abilities to work with scientific literature, use academic language, and analyse and systematize information are shaped through various written assignments. They develop student abilities to conduct an independent applied research. During their studies, students write various works, scheduled in the study programme, i.e. papers, essays, articles, course papers, projects/integrated projects, reports, and upon graduation, they write a professional bachelor's graduation paper (thesis). A student's academic writing experience begins with the development of independent work skills in various independent written assignments. Any of the papers must comply with the text layout requirements set out in the methodological requirements herein (Section 3). The structural parts of all written works must include: a title page, a summary, a table of contents, a list of tables and figures, an introduction, a development of the topic, conclusions, sources of literature and other information, and annexes.

All course descriptions always indicate the hours allocated for the students' independent work and provides more precise methodological requirements for the preparation. The scope of each independent work depends on the learning outcomes and scope of the study subject.

1.1. Types of papers

This subsection discusses aspects of the most common types of individual papers.

Summary report A summary report is a concise form of presenting information heard, seen, or read. A brief summary of what is most important can be done both orally and in writing (Kardelis, 2016). A summary report is an independent student work, the purpose of which is to provide a detailed examination of a specific theoretical issue, based on a discussion of scientific literature. Reports are among the first student assignments that contain elements of scientific work (Kardelis, 2016).

One of the keys of a summary report is to present the material in a concentrated, clear, purposeful and informative manner. A summary report can present an overview of theoretical material or empirical research, and analyse one or several important aspects of the issue raised. The most important criterion for the quality of a report is that the material presented is objective, purposeful, and informative (Kardelis, 2016).

Writing a summary report aims to develop student abilities to gather information on a chosen topic, analyse it, systematize it, and summarize it. By writing summary report, students develop the ability to identify scientific issues and make proposals to solve them. A summary report examines a certain topic (issue) based on various literary sources. The topic of a summary report can be chosen by students from a list provided by the lecturer, assigned to students by the lecturer, or proposed by students themselves, after consulting with the lecturer. When examining the research issue, students systematize sources of information and present their conclusions.

Summary reports are written using topical and scientific literature, legal acts, statistical and other sources of information. This type of a paper must be based on at least 4-10 sources of literature (recommended not only in Lithuanian, but also foreign languages).

Summary reports can be individual or delivered by a group (in the latter case, indicating the contribution of each student). The recommended length of an individual summary report is 10–20 pages (excluding appendices). The length of group summary reports is longer, defined by the lecturer.

Essay. An essay (French: *essai* – an attempt) is a structured and coherent, easy-to-read, short-form, argumentative academic paper. An essay is a piece of a student's written work, defined by a lecturer, the preparation of which helps develop scientific thinking and formulate statements. Questions raised in an essay can have more than one answer, while statements and issues may tackle completely different approaches.

Students writing an essay must provide a clear and reasoned critical view of the statements presented and issues examined in the scientific literature, identifying their advantages and disadvantages, proposing solutions, predicting future research directions, and inviting a discussion. Essays help to reveal the students' creative potential in combining scientific insights (and in some cases, personal experience) regarding the topic in question.

Although the essay structure is quite loose, the following parts are still necessary: introduction (raising the problem, intrigue), development of the topic (dividing the issue into parts, argumentation, supporting it with quotes, images), conclusions (main emphasis), literature and other sources of information, and annexes. Essays are subject to the same requirements for formatting and work structure as reports, but the scope of a scientific essay may be smaller (the specific scope is determined by the lecturer).

Report. A report is a written presentation of the works accomplished. Students usually write reports about their internships. Internships can be cognitive, educational, professional, or final. They take place at companies/institutions or practice enterprises. During internships, students perform tasks and assignments according to the methodological and/or internship supervisor's instructions, applying the theoretical knowledge acquired during their studies in practice. The goal of an internship is to develop the ability to relate theoretical knowledge to tasks performed in practical activities and

observed phenomena. An internship report is a written paper presenting a student's internship and describing the tasks accomplished. The purpose of an internship report is to develop skills in describing observed organizational activities, processes, and phenomena.

Writing an internship report involves using all kinds of information, student's individual observations, and other experience of the internship. Individual statements are illustrated with specific examples of the organization's activities, documents, calculations, interviews with employees, and process observation results.

When describing the work results, it is necessary to present them in a visual form: graphs, tables, pictures, formulas, numbers, statistical data. It should be noted that the information presented in tables and figures should not be repeating. Advanced students can present their calculations on opportunities to improve the company's performance. The scope of the internship report depends on the credits allocated for the internship – it is specified in the internship subject description and methodological requirements of the specific study program. The recommended length of an individual report is 10–15 pages (excluding appendices).

Reflection. A reflection is an independent student paper, the purpose of which is to help them rethink their activities and understand what was important and useful, what knowledge and skills they have acquired, and what skills they still need to strengthen in order to achieve better results. A reflection can be written after listening to a certain topic of a study subject, an entire subject, or after completing educational, professional, etc. internship. A Reflection includes both a description of the experience (tasks performed, what and was learned and how, how did the student feel), and reflection on the learning experience (what went well and what didn't, what could be done better next time, what difficulties or problems were encountered, how did the student solve them).

The lecturer teaching the subject should provide questions for reflection that will help to better assess the activity, experience, and usefulness, for example: *What were my goals? Did I manage to achieve them? What have I learned? What tasks have I completed? What was useful? What problems did I encounter? How did I solve them? What knowledge and abilities do I need to improve? What are the ways and how should I do it? Has my attitude towards this subject changed? Why?*

The specific scope and questions for the independent work presented in the form of a reflection are provided by the lecturer teaching the study subject (the suggested scope is 1–5 pages).

Project. A project/integrated project is a type of applied research work, similar to a course paper in scope and structure, which is based not only on theoretical studies, but also on practical experience. The starting point of any project is a specific problem in a relevant field. The exact requirements for the structure and scope of a project are specified by the lecturer.

Article. An article is a structured, coherent, small-scale academic paper of a theoretical and/or practical nature introducing research results or a valuable analysis of research results

conducted by scientists. An article can be written in Lithuanian or English language. Precise requirements for articles are usually provided in conference or article publication requirements. The length of an article is usually 5-7 pages.

A **course paper** is an independent research paper that presents and solves theoretical, applied or practical problems, but its scope is relatively smaller than that of a graduation paper/final thesis. Coursework can be integrated into a study subject or treated as a separate subject. If the course paper is integrated into a study subject, its writing and assessment are organized by the subject lecturer, following the subject description. If the course paper is treated as a separate study subject, the writing and assessment process is organized by the head of the department or an assigned lecturer.

Purpose of a course paper – to develop the student ability to use scientific literature, systematise, analyse and examine scientific and practical issues, applying proper research methods in order to obtain applicable results.

The **graduation paper of pedagogical studies** is a part of pedagogical, psychological and subject didactics studies, integrating theory and practice; it is an original, independently prepared, non-degree qualification paper, encompassing the theoretical and practical professional training of the future educator. It must be based on modern educational theories and a modern educational environment. In accordance with the Order of the Minister of Education and Science of the Republic of Lithuania *On the Approval of the Provisions for of the Group of Education and Training Study Fields* (<https://www.e-tar.lt>), the graduation paper of pedagogical studies is written by students of all pedagogy study programmes, offered at KVK.

The purpose of the **graduation paper of pedagogical studies** (hereinafter referred to as the **GPPS**) is to demonstrate the achieved study results by collecting, systematizing, reflexively and critically analysing, integrating and applying theoretical, practical, experiential, and empirical information about the objects and subjects of pedagogical activity.

A **graduation paper** is an original paper, independently written by a student with the aim to demonstrate the achieved study results by systematizing, reflectively and critically analysing, integrating and applying theoretical, practical, experiential, and empirical information. This paper must be publicly defended (KVK Procedure for Writing, Defence, and Storage of Graduation Papers).

The **purpose of the graduation paper** is to establish the level of student achievement of the study outcome, acquired during the studies to acquire vocational qualifications and vocational practice.

The **purpose of organising the assessment of the graduation paper (final project)** is to enable the student to prove that he or she has achieved the study objectives, and determine if he or she can be awarded with vocational qualifications.

Course and graduation papers are based on theoretical (resource analysis) and empirical research and analysis (Žydzūnaitė, 2011).

1.2. General provisions for course papers, GPPS and graduation papers

Students of all study programs of the Faculty of Business write course papers (students of study programs in the field of pedagogy write graduation papers of pedagogical studies). A study programme is regarded as completed upon completion, defence, and evaluation of the graduation paper or a graduation paper of pedagogical studies.

The writing, defence and evaluation of the graduation paper are subject to the General Requirements for the Conduct of Studies, the descriptions of study fields approved by the Ministry of Education, Science, and Sport, KVK study regulations, KVK Code of Academic Ethics, KVK Procedure for the Assessment of Study Achievements, KVK Procedure for the Submission and Examining of Appeals and Complaints, KVK Description of Plagiarism Prevention Procedure, KVK Procedure for the Management of Intellectual Property, KVK Procedure for Writing, Defence, and Storage of Graduation Papers, and the methodological instructions for writing papers for the studies, indicated herein.

Student/graduate duties. Students/graduates are free to choose the object and topic of their course paper, graduation paper or GPPS (a more detailed discussion about selecting the topic is provided in subsection 2.1. Selecting the topic). The responsibility for the quality of the course paper, GPPS, or graduation paper and compliance with formal requirements, correct data, calculations, and independent research falls on the student writing the paper alone. Students writing a course paper, a graduation paper, or a GPPS, must adhere to academic integrity and other ethical requirements defined in the Code of Ethics of KVK community.

Course/GPPS adviser duties. The adviser must encourage the author of the course paper or GPPS to find rational solutions on their own; therefore, the adviser does not provide the student with ready-made solutions, but only coordinates the course paper/GPPS writing plan, based on the given deadlines, controls the progress of the work, provides topical and methodological assistance, and consultations.

Graduation paper adviser duties. The adviser must encourage the author of the graduation paper to find rational solutions for the issue/topic in question. For this reason, advisers do not offer ready-made solutions, but only assist in compiling the work plan, control the course of the work based on the given schedules, offer topic and methodological assistance, suggestions for the improvement of the paper, and references to consultants (if needed).

Reviewer duties. Reviewers must objectively identify the strengths and weaknesses of the graduation paper and assess its compliance with the requirements specified in this methodology.

2. WRITING COURSE PAPERS, GRADUATION PAPERS FOR PEDAGOGICAL STUDIES, AND GRADUATION PAPERS

2.1. Selecting the topic

Themes for course papers and GPPS are provided at the departments on the first week of each semester. Students are free to choose the object and topic of their papers, based on the chosen theme. The graduation paper of pedagogical studies examines topics in education sciences, encompassing knowledge of theoretical pedagogy, applied pedagogy, psychology, and subject didactics. The student compiles the plan (topic, objective, problem, tasks, content, research methods) of the course paper, GPPS, or graduation paper, coordinates it with the adviser, and submits it to the department no later than the second week of the semester, during which the paper is being written (Annex 1). Academic departments certify course paper topics and the schedule for the research and defence on the third week of the semester. The schedule is introduced to the course paper and GPPS advisers and students.

The topics/directions of the graduations papers for the study programmes are announced on the second week of September, each academic year. Students can freely choose the object and topic of their final project, based on the theme chosen. Graduation paper topics, based on the theme/directions announced, can be suggested by students, lecturers, social partners, etc. Graduation papers, written, based on topics and themes, suggested by social partners, are regarded as commissioned graduation papers. When a student completes a graduation paper to solve a problem relevant to a specific organization, improve a process, etc., a representative of the organization fills out a feedback form on the commissioned graduation paper (Annex12) and evaluates the applicability of the submitted suggestions.

Based on the chosen theme, students formulate their graduation paper topic and objectives, compile a graduation paper writing plan (Annex 2), and coordinate it with their adviser. The coordinated graduation paper topic and plan must be submitted to the department on the last week of November. The list of preliminary topics, compiled by the head of the department, is certified at the department's meeting. The lists of graduation paper topics and advisers are certified by the Dean of the Faculty of Business on the second week after the end of the final internship. After that, graduation paper topics and advisers can be changed at the suggestion of the head of the department only for important reasons.

A single vocational bachelor's graduation paper research can be conducted by two students if the topic requires different fields of knowledge or abilities, or if the specifics of the topic requires to collect a larger amount of data.

When choosing the topic, object and theme of the course paper, GPPS, or graduation paper, students must objectively and realistically assess their capabilities to conduct empirical research, i.e. answer the questions: is there an organization in which the object of the research can be identified; is it possible to conduct such an empirical study in this organization (will the head of the organization allow the study to be conducted); will the collected data be reliable (will the number of respondents be sufficient, etc.), etc.

When writing course papers, GPPS, or graduation papers, it is necessary to obtain a permission from the head of the organization regarding the use of the organization's name and data (Annex 3). Upon obtaining such a permission, students/graduates of pedagogical studies conduct their research at pedagogical institutions (Annex 4). Upon obtaining a permission, the name of such organisation is featured in the title, content, and text of the course paper, GPPS, or graduation paper. In the event that the head of the organization does not allow the use of the name (but allows to conduct of the study and use the data) (Annex 5), the organization in which the study is conducted is mentioned in general or by indicating the field of its activity: a trading company, an institution, a hotel, a vocational school, a factory, a warehouse, a transport company, a forwarding company, a shop, a division of a manufacturing company, a department of a company, etc. The title cannot feature indications like *Company X* or *Institution Y*. If the permission regarding the use of the name was not obtained, only the permission to conduct a research must be submitted to the department. Permissions are provided in the course paper, GPPS, or graduation paper as Annexes.

A permission to use the organisation's data is not required if it is publicly available (e.g. budget data of the Republic of Lithuania, data from Statistics Lithuania, etc.).

2.2. Constituents of course papers, graduation papers of pedagogical studies and graduation papers

The structure of course papers, GPPS, and graduation papers consists of the following:

- Title page (Annexes 6, 7);
- Table of contents (Annex 8);
- List of tables and/or figures;
- Concept vocabulary;
- Summary in Lithuanian language (Annex 9);
- Summary in English language (Annex 9);
- Introduction;
- Theoretical part;
- Overview of the research method;
- Practical part;

- Conclusions and suggestions;
- Literature list;
- Annexes, mock-ups, models;
- Illustrations (bound separately if large or non-standard measurements).

Course papers may be both theoretical and practical.

In theoretical course papers, students present an analysis of various scientific works on the issue in question, systematising and summarising various theories. The issue is solved from a theoretical point of view by analysing scientific and didactic literature, and a theoretical solution to the problem is presented by analysing the opinions, theories and research, conducted on the issue in question by various scientists. The amount of literature reviewed in these course papers review must be larger (at least 20 sources) than in practical course papers. The summary of the literature sources in a theoretical course paper must correspond to the purpose and objectives of the paper. It is also recommended to compare the solution for the issue with the works, written by Lithuanian and foreign researchers.

In case of practical course papers, students present a theoretical analysis of the topic in question, analyse at least 15 literary sources to substantiate the interpretation of the empirical data obtained from them, and the results of an independently conducted empirical study. An empirical study can be either quantitative, or qualitative.

2.3. Title page, content

The **title page** of a course paper or a GPPS must contain the names of the university, faculty, and department; the title of the paper, the words *course paper* or *graduation paper of pedagogical studies*, the student's name, surname and signature, the position, academic title, name, surname, and signature of the course paper or GPPS adviser, and the place and year of writing the course paper or GPPS (Annex 6). The **title page of a graduation paper** must feature the names of the university, faculty and department; the title of the paper, the type of the paper and the state code of the study programme, the title of the field of study, the student's name, surname and signature, the position, academic degree, name, surname and signature of the adviser, the place and year of writing the graduation paper (Annex 7). The title pages must be written in font 12. Titles of the faculty and department, title of the course paper or a GPPS, or a graduation paper must be written in bold capital letters.

The title page of the paper is followed by the **table of contents**, indicating titles of the sections and subsections of the course paper, GPPS, or a graduation paper, and their page numbers (Annex 8). The table of contents itself is not included. The table of contents is compiled using the

automatic content function in *Times New Roman* 12 font.

Requirements for the table of contents of course papers, GPPS, and graduation papers.

- The main parts of the content – theoretical analysis, overview of research methodology, practical part – are written in capital letters, while their subsections and other parts of the paper – in lowercase, font size 12. The annexes, listed in the table of contents are provided in font size 10.
- Theoretical and practical parts (sections) must be divided into subsections (e.g., 2.1.; 2.2., etc.). Subsections, if necessary, can also be divided into smaller sections (e.g., 3.1.1.; 3.1.2., etc.). A section must have at least 2 subsections.
- Each numbered subsection of the theoretical and practical parts of the paper must have its own structure – introductory sentences, the main part and a summary; therefore a numbered part of the text of less than one page is insufficient. These parts must be evenly interconnected in implementing the goal and objectives of the course paper, a GPPS, or a graduation paper. Results should be described in a scientific style, and larger quantities of data should be presented in tables and graphs.
- If a student receives permission from a company manager to use the company name in their graduation paper, this must be indicated in the content. In cases, when the consent is not received, the organization of the research object is mentioned in the content in general or by indicating the field of activity: a trading company, an institution, a hotel, a vocational school, a factory, a warehouse, a transport company, a forwarding company, a shop, a division of a manufacturing company, a company department, etc. The title cannot feature indications like *Company X* or *Institution Y*.
- The content of the graduation paper must reveal that the student analyses the same aspects both in the theoretical and practical parts.
- The wording of the titles of theoretical and practical sections and subsections must be original, created by the author himself, and not copied from literary sources.
- Titles of the subsections of the practical part must correspond to the wording of the work tasks. If the task raised was to *evaluate* something, then the title of the appropriate subsection would likely end with the word *assessment*, etc. The title should preferably focus on what was done by the author: *...analysis*, *...improvement*, *...establishment*, *...opportunities*, etc. Otherwise, there might be an impression that the author is writing a report and does not present his personal opinion on the topic being analysed.
- The list of tables, figures, glossary, summary, introduction, conclusions and suggestions, bibliography, and list of annexes are not numbered (no numbers are written next to their titles).
- The content is generated in font 12; the list of annexes – in font 10.

2.4. List of tables

This section lists all tables, used in the course paper, GPPS, or graduation paper, and their titles. The list of tables is provided on a separate page, indicating the table number, the exact table title, and the page where the specific table is located.

For example:

List of tables	
Table 1. Planning steps	11
Table 2. Steps of developing an organisational management structure.....	18
Table 3. Price structure for the route Amberg (Germany) – Bury (Great Britain).....	27
Table 4. Multimodal route estimate Venspils (Latvia) – Plossberg (Germany).....	41
Table 5. Comparative analysis of routes.....	42

The list is generated using the automatic function for creating lists of figures. The list of tables is not numbered in the table of contents. If the course paper, a GPPS, or a graduation paper contains no tables, then this page will not be included in the paper.

2.5. List of figures

The list of figures is generated the same as the list of tables. The list is provided on a separate page, indicating the figure number, the exact figure title, and the page where the specific figure is located.

For example:

List of figures	
Fig. 1 Company's organisational management structure scheme	15
Fig. 2 Technological organization of cargo transportation.....	17
Fig. 3 Transport management system.....	18
Fig. 4 The company's demand for vehicles for foreign clients	22
Fig. 5 Operations of the company's managers	23
Fig. 6 Company order fulfilment scheme	31
Fig. 7 Real-time location of company vehicles	35
Fig. 8 Company vehicles that comply with Euro classification	40
Fig. 9 Route Ventspils (Latvia) – Plossberg (Germany) by road	41
Fig. 10 Multimodal route Venspils (Latvia) – Plossberg (Germany).....	42

The list of figures is not numbered in the table of contents. The list is generated using the automatic function for creating lists of figures. If the course paper, a GPPS, or a graduation paper contains no figures, then this page will not be included in the paper.

2.6. Concept vocabulary

This part presents the main concepts used in the graduation paper, their definitions, and sources. The vocabulary must consist of the key concepts, related to the topic of the paper, which must be specific and related to a specific field of activity. A concept can be treated as a combination of not just one, but also two or three terms. The vocabulary is needed to make sure that all concepts are interpreted in the same way. The general length of the concept vocabulary should not exceed 2 pages. One concept is defined in 1-2 sentences. The definition of the concepts should also include the source of literature used. For example:

Quantitative research is an empirical study, the conclusions of which are based on data analysis, conducted using mathematical statistical methods (Bitinas, Rupšienė & Žydžiūnaitė, 2008).

Qualitative research is an empirical study, which provides conclusions about the object of a research based on the analysis of qualitative data (expressed in the form of words or non-numeric symbols) (Bitinas, Rupšienė & Žydžiūnaitė, 2008).

The definition of a concept can also be created by the author of the course paper, GPPS, or a graduation paper. The author of the paper combines the ideas of several sources and authors, selecting those that correspond to the concept of the paper's topic and providing a specific summary in the vocabulary.

Concepts are defined using scientific resources (scientific articles, research reports, monographs, scientific studies), which describe and (or) research the concept used in the topic of the course paper, GPPS, or graduation paper. Concepts cannot be defined using textbooks, methodological books, or articles from newspapers or non-scientific magazines. If the student formulates the concept themselves using several sources, this must be indicated in the reference (for example, Source: compiled by the author based on...).

Whether this part is necessary for a specific paper should be decided by the author of the paper and his/her adviser.

2.7. Summary

This part is written, when the paper is finished. A summary begins with a continuous line indicating the author's name, surname, title of the paper, study programme, faculty, and university name in bold (Annex 9).

A summary briefly describes the **scientific/practical issue, research object, research objective, research methods, conclusions and suggestions, and 3-5 keywords**.

The key is to provide a brief and precise presentation of the results – the major conclusions and suggestions of the author. A summary should reflect the essence of the work and enable the reader to create an opinion about the importance and quality of the work. The description of the results focuses on generalisations. It is recommended to refrain from citing, tables, figures, or numerical data in the summary.

Summaries are provided in Lithuanian and English languages. If the course paper, GPPS, or graduation paper is written in English, the summary must be provided in English and Lithuanian languages.

Summaries in each language must be provided on a separate page. The length of a summary cannot exceed one page. Both texts must be provided on separate pages.

2.8. Introduction

Unlike the summary, the introduction should be started at the beginning of the paper. It is needed to keep the student focused instead of deviating from the topic being analysed. The introduction can be corrected or supplemented, when the entire paper is finished. It contains the major parameters of the graduation paper: **relevance of the topic, research problem, object, objective, tasks, research data collection and analysis methods**.

The **relevance of the topic** is emphasized in the first paragraphs of the introductory text. It can start with the more global relevance of the topic (to the world, to the country) eventually coming down to the importance of the topic to the subject of the analysis. The relevance of the chosen topic is based on the opinions or practical experience of other scientists and researchers. It should be substantiated by mentioning authors, who have examined aspects of the topic related to the chosen issue, indicating which aspects are already known and what new information will be learned after conducting the research. When emphasizing the relevance of a topic, it is necessary to pay attention to two aspects: whether the topic of the paper is relevant from a theoretical and practical point of view and to what extent that topic has already been researched and examined. It is necessary to mention national and foreign authors (sources), who have analysed this topic and applicable regulatory legislation. It is appropriate to indicate what makes the topic in question unique, compared to the previously conducted research and scientific literature published. The emphasis of the practical relevance should also include why this topic is important to the organisation, the processes or phenomena of which are chosen as the object of the research.

Research problem. The discussion of the relevance of the topic is followed by the research problem, which shows that the author has been familiar with the problem(s) in the field analysed even

before starting this work, is determined to investigate it (them) and deliver conclusions and suggestions. It shows the reason for further theoretical and empirical analysis, enabling us to expect that the results of the student's work will be meaningful. A discussion of the problem can show that there is a lack of research in a certain area, indicating a need to solve specific practical problems. It can also raise problem questions, which constitute the essence of the issue in question and are related to the content of the paper.

Research object – a phenomenon or process selected by the author of a coursework, GPPS or graduation paper for theoretical and practical analysis. A specific organisation is not a research object. In the methodological sense, a company or an institution is a research context, and practically – a research location. Thus, an object of a research can include an organisation's field of activity, process development opportunities, phenomena, relations, knowledge, facts, etc. While formulating the research object, it is necessary to consider the topic and purpose of the course paper, GPPS, or the graduation paper.

Research objective should be related to the title of the topic of the paper. The formulation of the purpose may indicate the necessity to adjust the title of the topic. The objective begins with infinitive verbs, for example: *to provide a methodological, empirical substantiation, to analyse, to research, to establish, to prepare*, etc.

Research tasks must reveal the essence of the paper, specify the purpose and become the starting point in creating the structure of the content of the theoretical and practical parts. Each subsection of the practical-analytical part could be directly related to one of the tasks. The recommended number of tasks is 3-5 at most. The tasks should begin with active verbs, such as: *to analyse, to research, to determine, to assess, to compile, to compare, to identify, to formulate, to shape, to define, to interpret, to check, to prepare, to create, to design, to emphasize, to align, to highlight, to solve, to illustrate*, etc. Sometimes research tasks are confused with methods and compulsory procedures. You cannot raise tasks like *to conduct a survey, provide conclusions and recommendations*. The tasks must be numbered.

The introduction indicates **research data collection and analysis methods** (based on the logics and course of the paper). The methods are listed in a line without numbering.

If the graduation paper is written by two students, the contribution of each of them is indicated in the introduction.

2.9. Theoretical part

In this part, the student must analyse relevant, up-to-date scientific, regulatory, and professional information that can substantiate the most important statements of the practical-research part.

Scientific literature analysis is a theoretical method that is based on the regularities established by theoretical thinking (philosophy, formal logic, psychology, etc.). A scientific study is initiated, conducted, and summarized after obtaining empirical research data. Theoretical methods in the process of scientific cognition provide the researcher with an instrument for a better understanding of the objects studied, clarify objective truth, and form scientific regularities, and the social value of objects and existing phenomena (Tidikis, 2003). The theoretical part of the graduation paper of pedagogical studies consists of an analysis of the chosen topic, prepared on the basis of the acquired professional competencies of a teacher (<https://www.e-tar.lt>).

The requirements for the theoretical part are presented below.

Each numbered subsection of the theoretical part of the paper must have its own structure – introductory sentences, the main part and a summary; therefore a numbered part of the text of less than one page is insufficient.

The theoretical part of the course paper, a GPPS, or a graduation paper must analyse relevant, up-to-date, scientific, regulatory, professional, and statistical information that helps to achieve the objectives of the practical-research part. Information (statements) from different sources must not only be presented, but also compared and summarised, indicating similarities and differences.

Plagiarism, and presenting other authors' ideas as one's own is strictly forbidden. **Plagiarism** is the appropriation of someone else's authorship, i.e. the presentation (use) of a text or part of a copyrighted object without indicating the actual author and source of that text, or by indicating it incorrectly (incompliance with citation requirements) / by providing a misleading reference (KVK Procedure for Writing, Defence, and Storage of Graduation Papers, 2018). Cited or paraphrased statements must include references. A **citation** is a relatively short excerpt from another work, intended to prove the author's statements, make them understandable, or to provide a reference to another author's views or thoughts formulated in the original (Law on Copyright and Related Rights of the Republic of Lithuania, 1999). It is recommended to avoid long citations, using paraphrasing instead. When citing foreign authors, non-Lithuanian male surnames in a coherent text must be grammatically adapted to the language of the text (recommendations for converting non-Lithuanian surnames in Lithuanian text are available in the *Recommendations regarding converting authentic surnames* at <https://www.vlkk.lt/aktualiausios-temos/svetimvardziai/gramatiminas>).

There must be at least three authors cited in each page. Citations, paraphrasing and any other use of information from various sources must come with references.

In the text, references to sources are written in parentheses, indicating the original surname of the cited author and the year of publication of the document, which must be separated by a comma, for example:

Dewey (2014) argues that as civilization develops, the gap between the demands of adults and the capabilities of their children is getting increasingly wider.

As civilization develops, the gap between the demands of adults and the capabilities of their children is getting increasingly wider (Dewey, 2014).

If the author is already mentioned in the sentence, there is no need to repeat their name in parentheses; indication of the year of publication is sufficient:

Bogart (2023) argues that the digital environment increasingly resembles a party with many rooms and individuals.

Sweis states that the majority of manufacturing organizations understand that implementing certification is a step towards continuous improvement (2022).

Kavaliauskaitė (2023) points out that, in recent years, the global experience in the application of the Internet of Things technologies and the latest research, the scale and application of services in business have been constantly growing and this trend will only increase in the future.

If the text provides an exact quote, then it must be written in italics or in quotation marks ‘...’; the author(s), year and page are indicated in brackets, for example:

Anger is an effect that simply symbolizes the pursuit of power and domination (Adler, 2023, p. 229).

In the process of transportation, logistics is responsible not only for the collection, consolidation and distribution of cargo, but also for the formation and implementation of the supply of transport services (the product) (Bazaras and Jarašiūnienė, 2022, p. 5).

Kavaliauskaitė (2023, p. 109) states that *the main challenges in logistics are related to transport and its management, considering transport as a key problem for the economy, sustainability and regional development*.

Or:

‘Anger is an effect that simply symbolizes the pursuit of power and domination’ (Adler, 2023, p. 229).

‘In the process of transportation, logistics is responsible not only for the collection, consolidation and distribution of cargo, but also for the formation and implementation of the supply of transport services (the product)’ (Bazaras and Jarašiūnienė, 2022, p. 5).

Kavaliauskaitė (2023, p. 109) states that ‘the main challenges in logistics are related to transport and its management, considering transport as a key problem for the economy, sustainability and regional development’.

It is necessary to maintain a consistent citation style throughout the work – choose either italics or quotation marks.

When a source consists of two authors' surnames, it is necessary to indicate both surnames in parentheses, separated by the conjunction *and*, for example:

(Paužuolienė and Pikturnaitė, 2022)

When citing sources with 3 to 5 authors, all authors must be listed when first cited, for example:

(Žvirelienė, Žostautienė and Kuvykaitė, 2014)
(Barynienė, Sukackė, Ukvalbergienė, Daunorienė and Gudonienė, 2023)
(Šimanskienė, Paužuolienė, Župerkienė and Fiore, 2019)

When citing a source for the second time, indicate only the first author's surname and the abbreviation, *et al.* instead of the other co-authors. Author surnames are provided in their original form, for example:

(Šimanskienė et al., 2020)
(Kotler et al., 2003)
(Дафт et al., 2009)

When citing sources with 6 or more authors, all references must include the first author's surname and abbreviation, *et al.*, for example:

(Anužienė et al., 2024)
(Silveira et al., 2023)

If several different sources are cited, the data in parentheses after the sources must be separated by a semicolon, followed by the authors' surnames in alphabetical order, for example:

(Aksamitaitė, 2008; Banelienė, 2015; Išoraitė, 2016)

If the author of the source used is a collective (association, institution, etc.), the first time you cite it, you must indicate the full name of the collective and its abbreviation in square brackets, for example:

(Klaipėdos valstybinė kolegija | Higher Education Institution [KVK], 2024)
(Lithuanian Marketing Association [LiMA], 2024)
(Lithuanian Practice Enterprise Association [LIBA], 2017)

In subsequent text references providing an abbreviation is sufficient, for example:

(KVK, 2024)
(LiMA, 2024)

(LIBA, 2017)

If the author or authors are not listed on the cover of the source, the name of the source should be written in italics when citing it, for example:

(A Brief Dictionary of German-Lithuanian and Lithuanian-German Languages, 2020),
(Žinių enciklopedija, 2019)

In case of multiple sources without authors, then the sources are listed in parentheses by name, and the data is separated by a semicolon, for example:

(A Brief Dictionary of English-Lithuanian and Lithuanian-English Languages, 2019; A Brief Dictionary of German-Lithuanian and Lithuanian-German Languages, 2020)

If the reference contains a title of a journal or book, then it is written in italics, for example:

(1000 Whys. A Children's Enciclopedia, 2024)
(An Illustrated History of Mankind for Children, 2023)

When citing different publications by the same author published in the same year, they should be distinguished by adding the letters a, b, c, etc. after the year of publication. Accordingly, these letters should be added to the year of publication and in the list of references, for example:

(Little, 2023a)
 (Little, 2023b)
 (Rimkutė-Ganusauskienė, 2023a, 2023b, 2023c)

When quoting or paraphrasing ideas from different publications by the same author, published in different years, the reference must include the author's last name and the year in ascending order, for example:

(Burvytė, 2017, 2018)
 (Paurienė, 2021, 2022)

If the surnames and works of different cited authors coincide, the initials of the authors' names must also be indicated in the references, for example:

(M. Jurevičienė, 2016); (D. Jurevičienė, 2017)
 Several sources in the same reference: (M. Jurevičienė, 2016; D. Jurevičienė, 2017)
 (W. Kenton, 2017); (Z. Kenton, 2022)
 Several sources in the same reference: (W. Kenton, 2017); (Z. Kenton, 2022)

When authors cite a secondary source, it is necessary to provide the details of the primary source, for example:

Ah Fook and McNeill (2020) indicate that... (as cited from Sidorčukaitė and Šakytė-Statnickė, 2021)

This concept means... (Ah Fook and McNeill, 2020, as cited from Sidorčukaitė and Šakytė-Statnickė, 2021)

Nangih, Ofor and Onuorah (2020) determined that... (as cited in Egwu, Orugun and Adelakun, 2021, p. 104)

Use this method only with sources that are not available as an original.

Legislation and laws, court cases must be cited as works without an author, that is, indicating the name of the source, for example:

According to the Law on Financial Incentives for Young Families Purchasing Their First Home of the Republic of Lithuania (2018), ...

(Law on Financial Incentives for Young Families Purchasing Their First Home of the Republic of Lithuania, 2018)

(Business Accounting Standard No. 1. Financial Reporting, 2015)

When citing, paraphrasing, or providing information from a website, authors are listed as they are for printed books and articles.

Hayes (2023)

(Hayes, 2023)

Bachtijeva, Tamulevičienė and Tvaronavičienė (2023)

(Official Statistics Portal, 2024)

(*Visuotinė lietuvių enciklopedija*, 2024)

(Eurostat, 2024)

When citing from an e-website, the reference in the text must be abbreviated and the detailed information about the source must be provided in the bibliography.

The purpose of crowdfunding is to raise funds for business projects, i.e. to obtain loans, sell issued transferable securities (<https://www.lb.lt/lt/>).

Since college study programs are focused on forming practical applied skills, in this part of the paper, students should also analyse professional practical empirical sources of information: opinions of authoritative experts, heads of organizations, specialists, presented in professional press, analytical radio and television programs, etc. The reliability of the sources must be discussed with the paper adviser. Online resources that do not include the author, year of publication, or title, or that are missing at least one of these components, cannot be cited or included in the bibliography. It is also advisable to avoid journalistic literature and online news portals (www.delfi.lt, www.15min.lt, etc.), where the information is often superficial, does not always present facts, or assess economic and business problems objectively. It is not appropriate to quote from publications in online

encyclopaedias such as *Wikipedia*, *Investopedia*, etc. Other student papers (vocational bachelor's, bachelor's and master's papers) cannot be used or included into the list of literature. Literature that was read, but not used for the paper, does not need to be included into the list. The work must be based on official statistical sources and scientific publications.

If tables, graphs and other visual material presented in the main parts of the work occupy an entire A4 page, this material must be presented in annexes.

This part is for the author of the paper to express his/her reasoned opinion, for example, *After analysing the information provided in scientific and professional sources, it can be stated that...* The author's thoughts are the source material should be clearly distinguished.

The subsections of the theoretical part (2.1., 2.2. etc.) end with short summaries in 2–3 sentences. They must be related to the title of the subsection and the essential aspects of the content. Smaller parts of the text (2.1.1., 2.1.2., etc.) do not need to be summarised. The summary may be followed by a concluding sentence that connects the completed subsection to the text that follows.

The volume of the theoretical and practical parts must be approximately equal. Therefore, at the end of the preparation of the paper, check for any theoretical analysis text that does not have important connections with the practical-research part, and discard it.

2.10. Overview of the research methodology

An overview of the research methodology should be reflected in at least 2-3 pages. This section should present the aspects discussed below.

2.10.1. Presentation of the organisation in which the research is conducted and the research object

Presentation of the organisation in which the research is conducted. The research methodology overview must provide the most important information about the organization in which the research is conducted: the nature and scale of activities, type, organizational management structure, achievements, etc. Unless there is written consent to use the name of an organization, providing data that would clearly identify the company, such as the exact address, any other unique, distinctive features, or functions performed, is unethical and prohibited. When presenting the organization under study to students, it is not recommended to copy material from the company's advertising texts, and identify with the company in phrases like 'we are...', 'our credo', etc. The presentation of the organisation should include only necessary information related to the object under study, and avoid a style inappropriate for a scientific text.

There should also be a brief presentation and justification of the **object of the research**, conducted at the organization. The most common research object chosen by students is a certain relevant phenomenon or area of activity, problems and opportunities for process development in companies and institutions. The current situation is described based on the content of the paper. It may also include an explanation of certain limitations and why other aspects are not analysed in a greater depth.

2.10.2. Justification of the research methods and process

The **research methods** used are indicated and described in detail below. Students must choose the most appropriate method or combination of research methods, taking into account their desired results and available data sources. It is necessary to justify the choice of research method. The list of methods used must indicate their exact titles. The paper may include both qualitative and quantitative research methods. It is recommended to start listing the research methods from the most important ones. In case of using tests and questionnaires, it is necessary to indicate, if they were developed by the author of the paper, or other authors. The content of the research instrument should be explained, including a description of its components and the type of questionnaire chosen.

This part also describes the **research process**, i.e. the stages that make up the research, when they were carried out (with precise start and end dates), what problems arose during their implementation, and how they were resolved.

2.10.2.1. Quantitative research methods and quantitative research sample formation

They are referred to as quantitative methods because their goal is to obtain quantitative information about a large number of objects (consumers, companies, or suppliers). Such studies are conducted when it is necessary to obtain accurate, statistically reliable numerical data. The traditional empirical quantitative research method is a *survey*. Its goal is to draw conclusions about the behaviour of the entire population from a small part (sample) of the population (Bilevičienė and Jonušauskas 2011; Bryman, 2016).

The following are the quantitative methods most commonly used in university student papers and the essential aspects of selecting the sample.

2.10.2.1.1. Written survey

According to Kardelis (2017), a **written survey** is the most popular method of sociological research. A written survey enables to survey groups of various sizes – from several dozen to several hundred people – in a short period of time. The essential feature of a written survey is that respondents answer the questions in writing (Kara, 2015). A written survey is a structured procedure for

interviewing a respondent, usually carried out using printed questionnaires that are distributed to large study groups. A distinctive feature of this method is that the questionnaire is completed by the respondent independently, without the intervention of a surveyor (Gaižauskaitė, Mikėnė, 2014). Therefore, a written survey is usually larger in scope and less personal in nature.

Preparation for a written survey. First, it is necessary to define, who will take part in the research, and the limits of competence of the subjects. This information is used to create the questionnaire. A **questionnaire** is a formalized set of questions to obtain information from respondents (Dikčius, 2011). It is compiled based on the research objective, tasks, and research questions – indicators. According to Dikčius (2011, p. 3), *the main task of a questionnaire is to ensure proper communication between the surveyor and the respondent. This questionnaire assignment revolves around three major aspects: first, it must contain specific questions that the respondent will be able and will have to answer. Both the questions and the possible answers provided ensure the ability to later compare different people's answers to the same question. Second, the questionnaire must motivate and encourage the respondent's involvement in the research, cooperation, and participation until the end of the survey. Lack of order in the questionnaire cause additional problems for the respondent in answering the questions, and at some point the respondent may refuse to continue participating in the survey. Unfortunately, information obtained during an incomplete survey usually cannot be used in data analysis, but obtaining that information required certain time and financial resources. Third, you must reduce response errors. They occur when a respondent provides inaccurate answers. Sometimes such answers may be deliberate, but it often happens that the question itself or even individual words of it lead the respondent towards the wrong answer. This leads to the provision of false information. To reduce these errors, the questionnaire needs to be well planned.*

General requirements for the questionnaire (Valackienė, Mikėnė, 2008; Kardelis, 2017):

1. First, there must be a motivated, logical explanation of who is conducting the research, why the research is being conducted, its purpose, and the procedure for using the results. Emphasize the importance and significance of the respondent's personal participation in the survey, and their open and fair responses. Guarantee the anonymity of the survey. Also, provide a short instruction on filling out the questionnaire.
2. The respondent's effort to answer must be minimal, so the questions must be specific with understandable answer options.
3. The less the respondent has to write, the more they trust that anonymity will be maintained.
4. The size of the questionnaire is important: a long questionnaire discourages the respondent, they get tired of reading it carefully resulting in superficial answers; the design of the

questionnaire and the composition of the questions are also important – this can mitigate any negative attitudes that may arise.

5. The initial questions are designed to capture the interest and engage respondents in communication, gradually involving them in the work. The purpose of subsequent questions is to obtain factual, event-based information known to the respondent. You should avoid questions that require only one answer. The questionnaire should end with easy questions that summarize the topic under consideration. Do not give questions that are too complex, difficult to understand, or may make the respondent nervous.

Recommendations for formulating questions (Kardelis, 2017):

1. Content of the questions: is the question necessary? What makes it useful? Do you need several questions or just the one? Does the respondent have the necessary information to answer the question? Will we get the information we ask for?

2. Wording of the questions: can the question be misinterpreted? Will the incorrect wording or emotional tone of the question make the answer unacceptable? Would an impersonal question be more effective?

3. Placement of questions in a questionnaire: will the previous question affect the answer to the following question? For example, if we ask a respondent, when they read fiction and then about their free time, the respondent may indicate reading as one of their favourite free time activities; in this case, we should ask about free time first and only then about reading. Is the sequence of questions good from a psychological point of view? Biographical data that is not interesting to the respondent should be provided at the end of the questionnaire. More intimate questions should also be postponed until the end, and a series of identical questions should include an occasional different one. Questions should go from simpler to more complex. Thus, ask the easier questions at the beginning.

Types of questions (Valackienė, Mikėnė, 2008):

1. **Open-ended questions**, i.e. questions that do not provide answer options. Advantages: the easiest way for the researcher to formulate a question with a high probability that the answer truly reflects the opinion of the subject. Disadvantages: respondents usually avoid or do not answer these questions at all, the answers received are difficult to record, categorize and code, and it requires a very high level of researcher competence to accurately record and interpret the thoughts expressed by respondents.

2. **Closed questions** that have multiple-choice answers. Advantages: respondents can quickly answer such questions because they are convenient and simple, data can be easily recorded and analysed, and misunderstandings can be avoided more easily. Disadvantages: it is difficult to anticipate all the answer options, and particularly difficult to formulate the question in a way that it is properly understood and the answer options are clear.

3. **Semi-closed questions** have a certain number of answer options and a line, where you can enter your own answer option if none of the provided answer options are suitable. Advantages: similar to closed questions. Advantages: similar to open-ended questions.

Conducting a written survey. The respondent completes the questionnaire independently, and can choose the speed of completion that is right for them, as well as a convenient time and place. There is also more privacy with no discomfort that may arise when answering some (especially sensitive or personal) questions directly to the researcher. Respondents feel like they can answer the questions more openly and honestly. When completing the questionnaire themselves, respondents can reread an unclear or difficult question, avoiding the potential inconvenience of having to ask the interviewer to repeat the question (Ornstein, 2013, Gaižauskaitė, Mikėnė, 2014). On the other hand, when only the questionnaire filling process involves the respondent alone, it is important to make sure that they can understand the questions; therefore the questionnaire must have a sufficiently clear structure, the questions must be easy to understand, and complex filtering steps should be avoided. In addition, completing questionnaires independently leaves an opportunity to skip questions, leave the questionnaire incomplete, which is particularly relevant to open-ended questions. Also, if the questionnaire instructions are not clear enough, there may be more incorrectly answered questions.

Data analysis and interpretation. Kardelis (2002, 2017) highlights several tips on proper analysis and interpretation of data collected through written surveys: 1) It is customary to use the impersonal grammatical form to describe the results obtained. For example, instead of writing ‘the results obtained in my research...’, write ‘the results of the research...’; 2) there are two main methods of graphical data presentation: tables and figures (graphs, diagrams, etc.). Data that is examined using logical analysis is presented in tables, while an entire phenomenon or development trends are better illustrated using visuals; 3) scientific ethics using tables or figures published by other authors without indicating their source; 4) illustrative material and descriptive text must complement, not duplicate each other. Thus, listing all numbers, indicated in a table is has no purpose. The task of a descriptive text is to direct the reader towards the principles of creating visual material, based on characteristic indicators; 5) it is important to refrain from overloading the text with too many tables or pictures, as this makes it difficult to read.

2.10.2.1.2. Online survey

Compared to other survey methods, respondents may find an **online survey** more convenient, especially if the target group consists of younger or middle-aged people belonging to a population that is used to using a computer. In addition, a questionnaire prepared with special software is much more convenient to fill out due to a more efficient question filter use, allowing you to automatically jump to the required question, skipping those that the respondent no longer needs to

answer, depending on the previously selected answers, and also wider questionnaire design options. For example, some questions can be presented in a visual form (e.g., videos, etc.); the questionnaire can be designed in a way that respondents with visual impairments can have the questions read aloud or use the option of increasing the font size, etc. (Gaižauskaitė, Mikėnė, 2014).

Surveys online offer a greater chance that the respondent will provide a true and honest answer. Moreover, these answers will be more open than in cases, when the survey takes place face-to-face. That is because, in an online survey, respondents feel safe realising that no one knows the answer options but themselves, etc. (Cornell, 2022)

Online research has a prerequisite – sufficient technological literacy of the researcher and research participants, because not all people are able to use technological tools.

During the **preparation phase**, the researcher must remember three main questions: How to get the respondent's attention? What can be offered to the respondent? What platform is best for conducting an online survey?

Choosing the right online platform is important not only for the conduct of the research and its success, but also for data processing. The major platforms that students most often use are *Google Forms*, *www.apklausa.lt*, *Zohosurvey*, *SurveyNuts*, *Surveymonkey*, *Surveyplanet*, *Jotform*, etc.

Conducting an online survey guarantees access to data worldwide, minimal time investment of time and resources, and different tools for collecting information (e.g., e-mail, QR code, embedded systems/websites, etc.). The recommendations for preparing questions for an online survey (Kardelis, 2017) are the same as for a written survey (see pp. 20–23).

2.10.2.2. Qualitative research methods

Qualitative research includes very different research methodologies, which are divided into several large groups: *focus* groups; in-depth (personal) interviews; semi-structured (formalized) interviews; observations; projective methods; associative methods; document content analysis; case studies; expert evaluation, etc. (Bilevičienė and Jonušauskas, 2011; Bryman, 2016; Žydžiūnaitė and Sabaliauskas, 2017). Qualitative methods examine words, images, and imagined (subjective) things. Most often, qualitative research is the beginning of quantitative research. Qualitative research is limited to a small number of informants, so the results of the research method usually cannot be generalized to the entire population. Qualitative research provides a lot of valuable information that helps clarify and precisely define problems, which is why it is used by many researchers.

Further below is general information about the most commonly used qualitative research methods.

2.10.2.2.1. Structured and semi-structured interview

In order to get a better understanding of a phenomenon, process or object under study, information can be collected through interviews. An **interview** is usually defined as a conversation between a researcher and a subject (informant) with the purpose to collect information necessary for the study, and the conversation takes place by asking and answering questions. An **interview** is a way to gather knowledge about various phenomena or learn about personal experience (Gaižauskaitė, Valavičienė, 2016). The advantage of this type of communication is that subjects express their thoughts and emotions naturally and spontaneously. The researcher focuses on the personal experiences of the study participants in order to understand how people perceive and make sense of their lives. However, the researcher must remember that the interview also involves the assessment of the interaction between the researcher and the research participants, and how the subjects respond to the questions asked, ensuring that they feel comfortable (Žydzūnaitė, Sabaliauskas, 2017).

The interview is based on open-ended questions, expecting to receive the broadest, most detailed, and most open answers possible, formulated and presented by the research participants (informants), reflecting on their perspective. An interview involves an in-depth exploration of opinions, attitudes, experiences, motives, feelings, etc. The researcher must ask questions in a way that encourages the research participant to speak, present their point of view, and open up (Gaižauskaitė, Valavičienė, 2016, p. 80). The literature mentions a wide variety of interview methods most commonly used in peer studies (Žydzūnaitė, 2006, p. 46, Brunt et. al., 2017, p. 151):

1. A structured interview, where the subject is interviewed using a prepared questionnaire, strictly following the order of the questions (Žydzūnaitė, 2006, p. 46).
2. A focused or semi-structured interview, which has a plan, highlighting only the main aspects, but the order of the questions is not determined (Žydzūnaitė, 2006, p. 46).

Students, who are just beginning to gain experience as researchers, are recommended to choose a structured or semi-structured interview method. The general steps of applying the interview method are provided below.

Preparation for an interview. The researcher preparing for an interview must compile a questionnaire consisting of open-ended questions (without providing the subjects with answer options). The questions must cover the entire subject of the study. A structured open-ended questionnaire does not deviate from the purpose and direction of the research, maintaining a certain order, and research participants answer clear, specific questions, which makes it easier to sort, compare, and analyse the information when processing data and preparing a research report. The introductory questions in the questionnaire are usually broad and general, designed to start a conversation and somewhat touch on the topic of the interview. Gaižauskaitė and Valavičienė (2016) mention question formation strategies like *thematic blocks* and subsections, recommending to give

the more general questions first, and then follow with questions that are more specific and detailed. Preferably, the research questions should correspond to the theoretical part of the student's work, i.e., there should be questions from all subsections of the theoretical part. Questions may be about the experiences, behaviours, places, environments, formal and informal roles, relationships, opinions, values, feelings, etc. of the individuals participating in the study. The end of the interview questionnaire often includes a question whether the research participant would like to add anything to their story that was not asked about, but that they think is important. Literature recommends to refrain from questions that are interrogative and lead to short answers, using questions that encourage the sharing of information instead, e.g. start with *how*, *what*, *when*, *who*, or asking to tell, indicate, convey an experience, etc.

Selecting research participants (informants). Qualitative research and interviews involve research searching for participants (informants), whose personal experience, characteristics, and social contexts would enable them to answer the research questions in the most accurate and comprehensive way. Moreover, such research needs *participants whose special, specific characteristics would enable them to best reflect and/or inform about the phenomenon studied* (Gaižauskaitė, Valavičienė, 2016, p. 37). The goal of the research defines the most appropriate and informative target population (who will be able to provide the most necessary and/or essential information about the phenomenon studied, and whether there are different subgroups (group diversity) that can provide different opinions about the phenomenon under study). It is also necessary to select participants, who represent a variety of positions related to the research subject and best reflect possible significantly different experiences. More details on selecting the informants and research participants are provided in the publication by Gaižauskaitė and Valavičienė (2016, pp. 36–44). The research sample (the total number and composition of interviewees) can be finalized during the processes of data collection and analysis.

Research scope (number of research participants). Without experience of conducting interviews, it is recommended to make the decision of the sample size in two stages: at the beginning of the study, consider and justify the initial expected number of study participants (for example, five or six interviews), and after conducting these interviews, decide whether the collected data is truly sufficient to answer the research questions. If the data collected does not seem to be sufficient, make the decision on how many additional interviews are needed.

Data collection/interview. When planning an interview, it is necessary to assess and discuss how much time the interview would take with the research participants in advance. The length of interviews is directly related to the topic and number of questions, the researcher's ability to interview the subjects, and if the subjects are talkative or not. However, most interviews last 0.5–1.5 hours. An interview can be conducted directly between the researcher and the subject or using information and

communication tools (telephone conversation, remote communication tools (MS Teams, Google Meet, Messenger, etc.). Comfort, privacy, silence, and peace are among the most important characteristics of an interview environment. Most often, an interview conversation is recorded using various audio recording devices (e.g., telephone, recorder, specialized applications). Thus textual information is fully and accurately recorded, making it easier for the researcher to control the conversation and note non-verbal information (facial expressions, gestures, changes in voice tone, etc.), as this is just as useful information as words. Video recording is more typical for specific discussions and is rarely used for individual interviews, as it disturbs the research participant too much (Gaižauskaitė, Valavičienė, 2016, p. 108). In addition, the interviewee must be informed about the recording of the interview in advance, explaining the purpose of the recording (for example, to ensure the accuracy of the information), and obtaining research participant's consent to make an audio and/or video recording.

At the beginning of the interview, the researcher must introduce himself, explain the purpose, inform about the recording, ask the research participant to tell about the essential social/professional characteristics of the research participant, which would reveal his awareness of the topic, etc. The researcher must be able to maintain a conversation, reformulate or clarify the question, and encourage the research participant to open up. The researcher must also be prepared or have thought about unexpected situations, for example, if the research participant/informant becomes agitated, starts crying, reacts suspiciously to questions, etc. While listening to the response, the researcher must interpret whether he or she understands what the research participant wants to say – if not, ask one or more clarifying questions, ask the informant to explain the meaning of the words or expressions used; reflect on whether the content of the response really includes what the researcher wants to know – if not, it is necessary to immediately decide what additional questions could be asked so that the informant understands the purpose of this interview. During actual interviews, research participants often respond in unexpected ways – their answers are too short, too narrow, or they do not understand the question. In such cases, it is appropriate to ask the research participant to provide an example or a more detailed explanation. Also, during the interview, the researcher must observe the research participant's behaviour, non-verbal language, and the interview environment.

Preparing the interview data for analysis. The information collected during interviews is processed by making verbatim interview transcripts, which are presented in the interview protocols as work annexes (see Annex 10). These annexes are numbered and their number must represent the number of the research informants. While making a transcript, it is necessary to neutralise the data of the research participants to ensure their anonymity. Research participants/informants are coded or numbered, for example, the first research participant is coded as D1, the second – D2, etc. Transcripts include demographic, social or professional characteristics of the research participants; location,

date/time, duration; the researcher's questions and the research participant's answers are presented sequentially according to the interview. The audio recording of the interview is converted into a written word-for-word text. Transcripts enable us to ensure correct application of the method, correct citing, thorough analysis, and correct interpretation. At this stage, it can be decided whether the information collected is sufficient for data analysis and formulation of the results. If the informants, who participated in the study were silent and did not provide sufficient information, it may be necessary to seek for additional respondents.

Data analysis and interpretation. The validity and meaningfulness of the results of a qualitative study is directly related to the richness of the information provided by the case selected. *Qualitative data analysis is the systematic arrangement of collected information and the search for connections* (Gaižauskaitė, Valavičienė, 2016, p. 315). In scientific literature, data analysis and interpretation is divided into the stages of data decomposition, data integration, and data interpretation, as well as drawing conclusions (for more information, see Gaižauskaitė, Valavičienė, 2016, p. 343). Qualitative data analysis means structuring textual information collected during research, interpreting it, and searching for causal relationships and continuities. When structuring qualitative data, interview excerpts and respondent statements should be presented in tables of categories, subcategories, and supporting statements (see Annex11). The analysis involves interpreting what the research participants said, searching for certain patterns by comparing what was said in one interview with what was said in another, and by linking the information said by different research participants.

2.10.2.2.2. Focus group

Focus group method is classified as a group interview method that is used to obtain qualitative data when conducting qualitative research (Rupšienė, 2007; Gaižauskaitė, Valavičienė, 2016). The focus group method is explained as (Rupšienė, 2007; Bitinas, Rupšienė, Žydžiūnaitė, 2008):

1. a qualitative research format for collecting detailed descriptive data in small groups, the participants of which agree to focus on a topic of interest to all present;
2. a type of in-depth interview that involves an interaction in a small group (6–12) of people, who share the same characteristics and who answer questions posed by other group members and ask their own;
3. a form of a group interview, when there is interaction between group participants, which becomes evident when discussing the research question;
4. a form of research that emphasizes the experiences, interests, attitudes, perspectives, and opinions of group participants.

According to Bitinas, Rupšienė, Žydžiūnaitė (2008, p. 169), the distinctive features of the group discussion method are as follows:

1. a small number of group participants (usually 8–12 people);
2. the group work is led by a moderator, who encourages discussion among group members;
3. each group participant is encouraged to express their opinion on the research question, ask questions and answer questions from other group members;
4. group participants are selected based on a common characteristic (sociodemographic background, experience, interests, etc.), therefore, they have common experiences or are connected by common interests;
5. during the interview, the discussion of the problematic issue is directed in a way that helps the researcher understand what is happening.

The group discussion method includes elements of an interview and observation. However, the most important element of the method is the interview, where the added value lies in the active interaction and relationship of the research participants (i.e. opinions, attitudes, approaches, experiences, evaluations, beliefs, etc.) with the topic researched (Rupšienė, 2007; Bitinas, Rupšienė, Žydžiūnaitė, 2008; Gaižauskaitė, 2012; Gaižauskaitė, Valavičienė, 2016).

Preparing to moderate a focus group. According to Bitinas, Rupšienė, Žydžiūnaitė (2008, p. 175), *the person moderating the group discussion is referred to as a moderator*. This could also be the researcher, who has the necessary competencies to moderate a focus group discussion. The moderator is fully responsible for the application of this method. The work of the focus group, engaged in a discussion, led by the moderator, is referred to as a session. However, it is necessary to carry out some preparatory work before the session, which will determine the quality of the data collected during the session. Since a focus group explores a specific topic, before starting the session, the researcher should list all the questions that he or she believes are necessary to answer the main research issue and that need to be explored in the group. The focus group discussion leader must select the group participants and coordinate their participation (verbally, in writing). A few days before and in the evening, the moderator reminds the group participants about the working hours they have planned. The time and length must be coordinated with the group participants. The group's workplace is coordinated with the group participants and, if necessary, determined by the researcher himself. Knowing the location where the group work will take place, the moderator must consider the seating of the participants. Whatever furniture is in the room, it must be arranged so that the seated group members can see each other's faces. To ensure interaction between group participants, it is a good idea to provide each group participant with a name card. The group moderator must consider the entire course of the session, from the group participants' welcome to farewell, the basic rules of the group's work, and the main elements of the work. The group moderator must plan the method of

recording the session data (using video and audio recording equipment or not) and coordinate this with the group participants (Rupšienė, 2007).

Application of the focus group method. A discussion session usually lasts 1.5-2 hours, but can be shorter depending on the objectives of the study. The main part of the group discussion/focus group session is a discussion of the research questions. The moderator asks questions, clarifies, asks additional questions, and asks for a more detailed explanation or justification of their opinion. During this session, it is not enough to simply ask the questions; the moderator must also receive detailed answers to these questions. Group participants rarely give detailed answers. Therefore, the moderator must be able to talk the group participants into providing the desired information. Major questions and statements: *Why yes? Why not? Please give more detail! What did you do? What do you use? Why didn't you do/use something?* etc. (Rupšienė, 2007; Bitinas, Rupšienė, Žydžiūnaitė, 2008). According to Gaižauskaitė, Valavičienė (2016, p. 148), *the information produced by group discussions is both verbal and non-verbal, which supplements the data collected. In addition to individual aspects of non-verbal language, it is also possible to observe elements of group interaction: the development of the discussion and new questions among the participants, emergence of other topics, resolution of disagreements on the issues under discussion, etc. Sometimes non-verbal information not only significantly complements verbal information, but can also be much more eloquent.*

At the end of the group discussion, the moderator must immediately check if the discussion data has been recorded. Then the moderator writes down their reflections and observations about the session that took place (Rupšienė, 2007; Bitinas, Rupšienė, Žydžiūnaitė, 2008).

The preparation of the group discussion data for analysis, as well as the analysis and interpretation of data is carried out in exactly the same way as in the case of an individual interview. This was discussed in more detail in section 2.10.1 *Structured and semi-structured interviews* (see pp. 24–26).

2.10.2.2.3. Case study

Researchers deciding to conduct **a case study** work in a natural environment, without making any impact on the situation studied, but looks for explanations that help to better understand their observations (Kardelis, 2017). By applying this method, the researcher delves into the subtleties of the behaviour or activities of people or institutions, the analysis of complex relationships, and the expression of the impact of unforeseen factors, i.e. the characteristics of the object (Bitinas, Rupšienė & Žydžiūnaitė, 2008).

What makes the case study method stand out as an independent form of research from others is not the methods, but the focus on the individual, single case. This case can be a person, a group, an

episode, a process, a community, a society, or any other element of social life. The researcher collects all relevant and available data (*Visuotinė Lietuvių enciklopedija*, 2023).

A case study is usually conducted to achieve one of three goals: to provide a vivid description (to clarify contexts, meanings, intentions), to provide explanations (the researcher needs to learn why the situation is the way it is or why the individual behaves in a certain way), and to provide evaluations (to evaluate the environment, programme, method, etc.) (Charles, 1999).

Data collection. Researchers using the case study method must collect data from multiple sources in order to analyse the case under study as a whole. Some researchers recommend combining quantitative and qualitative data collection methods, believing them to be equally useful, while others suggest using only qualitative data exclusively. Researchers may apply testing, written and oral interviews, and document analysis, but the bulk of data is collected through direct observation by the researchers themselves (Yazan, 2015). This approach is also followed by Hamilton (2011), who states that a case study is used to create a holistic picture of the research object, using various data collection methods, as they can provide the researcher with detailed insights into the experiences of participants in a specific context.

Data analysis methods. A typical feature of a comprehensive case study is that it enables to collect a considerable amount of data, expressed in words, images, objects, and sometimes numbers. There are three types of data analysis using a single case study method: interpretive (the aim is to explain a phenomenon), structural (the aim is to find recurring patterns), and reflective (the aim is to describe or evaluate a phenomenon based on intuition and imagination; this type of analysis is subjective and does not have standard procedures). The data of a single case study method is analysed in several stages: highlighting themes, that is, recurring characteristic features, grouping them into categories, using these categories to create models, and then interpreting those models in order to answer research questions or test the hypotheses raised (*Visuotinė lietuvių enciklopedija*, 2023).

2.10.2.2.4. Document content analysis

Document analysis method refers to primary data collection, when documents are used as primary sources of information. Documents differ from each other in origin, availability, etc. Some documents are created by state institutions, others – by private structures and business enterprises. Text and audio recordings are stored by many agencies, making them available to researchers and referred to as *public official documents*. Document analysis may also involve documents that are not public, such as school records, social work records, health examination records, social work records, police records, court records, and others. Commercial companies keep records of decisions made and financial transactions. Such material must be kept confidential or made available in a form that keeps

individuals confidential. Document analysis requires adherence to certain principles. First, selecting sources of information and defining the scope of the selection. The selection of the documents must ensure that the information is reliable and valid. When checking reliability, it is necessary to perform an external (conditions of creating the document) and internal (document content) analysis (Tidikis, 2003).

The effectiveness of using documents in a research may depend on the specific documents used and how they are used. Documents can provide useful information about the culture of the organization and the people working in it, project implementation, and personal attitudes and values of the subjects. Documents can be useful as:

- the main data collection method (may be supplemented by other data collection methods, such as interviews or observation);
- an additional data collection method (for example, in the preparatory interview stage, when developing a questionnaire, or in the preparatory observation stage, when deciding what to observe);
- as one of the data collection methods (Rupšienė, 2007).

The researcher describes why the specified data collection strategy was chosen and what means were used to achieve data diversity. Data analysis is conducted with documents that would ensure the reliability and validity of the information.

In the case of document analysis, according to Rupšienė (2007), there are no clear rules for determining the sample size. The **research sample** can be quantitative (for example, 118 CMR consignment notes of one month from one logistics organization) and qualitative (for example, one CMR consignment note of one logistics organization and the information contained therein, and information provided in the company's balance sheet). In this section, it is necessary to describe the criteria used to select the texts for the analysis. Also, define and justify the sample size of the study, for example, indicate which documents would be used for data collection and why.

Data collection. Document analysis requires adherence to certain principles; therefore, first, we need to select the sources of information and define the scope of the selection. The selection of the documents must ensure that the information is reliable and valid (Tidikis, 2003). The data is collected from written, printed or electronic documents relevant to the study – legal acts, operational documents, financial reports. Only the data relevant to the research must be collected.

Data analysis method. Document analysis is conducted using classical (qualitative) and content analysis methods (Kudinovienė, 2008). The **classical analysis** method involves obtaining qualitative information on the basis of a large sample. This is an analytical review that presents systematized, logically structured results of the research conducted, illustrated with tables, diagrams, data maps, and other visual aids. Data analysis includes an assessment of the reasons for changes in

various events, indices, and their interrelations, and future predictions. If the data was analysed using computer software (*Kokybis, NVivo, Text Analysis Suite* etc.) it should be mentioned as well. The **content analysis method** is a quantitative analysis of social information. In the most general sense, content analysis is a technique that enables to draw reliable conclusions after objectively and systematically examining the features of a text. The essence of this method is to isolate certain semantic units in the text of a document, then calculate the frequency of their use, and study the relationships of various text elements both with each other and with the entire volume of information (Tidikis, 2003).

2.10.2.2.5. Observation

Observation is regarded as: 1) direct sensory perception of actual events; 2) a method of collecting primary social information, when research data is collected by the researcher purposefully recording observed events, phenomena and processes occurring in natural conditions. This is a particularly valuable method of collecting research data: applied purposefully and systematically, it enables to obtain data about events, behaviour, and processes occurring in the natural environment that do not change or influence the course of these events, i.e., to see reality as it is (Tidikis, 2003). Scientific observation differs from non-scientific observation in that:

- it has a clear research goal and strictly formulated objectives;
- it is planned according to a model formed in theoretical analysis;
- it records observation data in protocols according to a certain system;
- the information thus obtained is controlled, reasonable and stable;
- the data is recorded using not only direct observation, but also technical measures;
- it has a hypothesis of the aspect studied, which is confirmed or refuted by the facts obtained;
- the observer has mastered the observation technique and has accumulated personal experience (Tidikis, 2003).

Observations can be included (covert), excluded (open), introspective, standardized, non-standardized, partially standardized, field, laboratory, laboratory-field, systematic, random, episodic, using technical data recording tools, without using technical data recording tools (Kardelis, 2017, Tidikis, 2003, Adomaitienė, Zubrickienė, 2019). Valackienė and Mikėnė (2010) identify structured observation as a quantitative research method, and unstructured observation as a qualitative research method.

The observation method is appropriate for cases where informants do not know the exact answers (for example, preschool children) or the aim is to get to know the physical environment of the problem studied, gain a better understanding of interpersonal relationships, examine details of

certain events (projects, programmes), and investigate non-verbal communication (Adomaitienė and Zubrickienė, 2019).

The main requirements for observation are as follows: observation must have a specific goal; the number of characteristics observed must be optimal and precisely defined; observation must take place according to a pre-determined plan – where does the observation take place, when, how, what is the object and how long would the observation take place; data obtained during observation must be comparable. Uniform evaluation criteria should also be applied (Adomaitienė and Zubrickienė, 2019).

Research scope. One of the relevant methodological questions is how many observations should be made? This is not as relevant if the researcher is a member of the group observed, but it is important if the observer comes from the outside. There are no strict rules. The main recommendation is to observe more than once and, if possible, to take a longer pause between observations (Rupšienė, 2007).

Data collection method – in case of observation, there must be an indication of what type of observation was chosen (unstructured or semi-structured) and why; how the observation was carried out – what days were chosen, what was the observation time (in hours) for each day, and why this particular time period; what was the duration of the entire observation in days; the conditions, environment, and premises the observation was carried out in; object of observation – a person, a group of people, the work of a department, or human interactions and statements why this particular object of observation was chosen; whether the observation was carried out in several stages, and what was the content of each stage; in case there was a preparatory stage, then it should also be described – what was done and why; also, a description of how the observation data was entered – separate computer files or one (Žydzūnaitė, 2011).

During an observation, data is recorded in an observation protocol (see Annex 12), an observation matrix, or in reflection notes, which are submitted as annexes to the paper.

Observation data is recorded in an **observation protocol**, which consists of:

- descriptive notes: description of the physical environment, events, activities, brief reconstruction of dialogues that took place, drawings, portraits of participants, etc.;
- reflection notes: the researcher's personal thoughts, feelings experienced during observation, insights for future data coding, analysis, interpretation of results, ideas for improving the course of the research, etc.;
- information relevant to the study may also be recorded: time, duration, location of a specific observation, etc. (Morkevičius, Telešienė, Žvaliauskas, 2008).

An **observation matrix** means that a student, having analysed the theoretical material and prepared the theoretical part of the paper, creates a table indicating specific criteria according to which

the observation will be carried out. In the table, each criterion must be detailed with indicators, and the latter must be described during the observation. In this way, the researcher obtains focused observation material and uses it to mark how many times a specific action, interaction, dialogue, etc. occurred and repeated during a specific observation period. (Žydžiūnaitė, 2011).

Data analysis method. The most commonly used method is the content analysis. This is an analytical review that presents systematized, logically structured results of the research conducted, illustrated with tables, diagrams, data maps, and other visual aids.

2.10.2.2.6. Action research

Action research is designed to create new knowledge in order to find a specific solution to a problem or discover a solution in a problematic situation. One of the distinctive features of action research is the active and deliberate participation of the researcher in the research being conducted. Unlike other empirical studies, in which the researcher is considered impartial towards the participants, in action research the researcher is considered a key participant in the research process and collaborates with other participants. This method is focused on the study and improvement of the professional/social activities of the individual (who becomes the researcher). Action research is usually undertaken by a person, who seeks to investigate their own activities. The most important thing here for the researcher is to examine various aspects of the action and propose specific solutions for its improvement (Adomaitienė and Zubrickienė, 2019). This is important for social sciences, whose purpose is to suggest ways to improve the work with people or their groups (for example, for management, education, social work, and nursing specialists). The researcher, while improving the experience he/she already has, relies on the principle of social cognition: *research by taking action*, and *taking action while researching* (Bitinas, Rupšienė and Žydžiūnaitė, 2008).

The application of action research in an educational institution is related to the professional growth of the educator (Norton, 2009; Efrat, Ravid, 2013). The object of research is certain problems in a specific environment (e.g. pedagogical). For example, in a pedagogical environment, action research can investigate the opinions of learners, the development of certain skills, the application of different teaching methods and/or application of methods at different times of the activity or while working with different groups of learners (for more information, see Efrat, Ravid, 2013).

Action research inherently focuses on activity, which is simultaneously a method of information gathering and practical activity (Naujanienė et al., 2016). These studies are conducted in a natural environment, e.g., in the educational process (in other words, to study the phenomenon itself and its course), rather than in an isolated, artificially created environment (Adomaitienė and Zubrickienė, 2019). During the research, the researcher actively participates in the process being studied and carries out activities that result in significant changes in performance outcomes. The

researcher aims that these changes would be planned by the participants themselves, while the researcher creates favourable conditions, encouraging the participants to delve deeper into their activities and behaviour (Bitinas, Rupšienė and Žydzūnaitė, 2008).

There are two main categories of action research: descriptive research, which aims to find out what is happening in a given environment, and a research designed to test a hypothesis or a chosen innovation, implemented by the researcher (Sagor, 2005).

Organising action research. Researchers indicate a different number of stages in the implementation of performance research, from four (Sagor, 2005), five (Norton, 2009) to a detailed six (Efrat and Ravid, 2013) stages. However, researchers applying action research typically go through a cycle of research, action, and reflection phases (the so-called action/action research cycle), consisting of four main elements: identifying the problem, action planning, execution, and evaluation (see Fig. 1). Since during the cycle it usually becomes clear that various elements that were not taken into account in the original action plan, can be improved as well, researchers move from one cycle to the next. Thus emerges the so-called action research spiral, which illustrates the complex and iterative nature of this approach (Góral, Jałocha, Mazurkiewicz and Zawadzki, 2021).

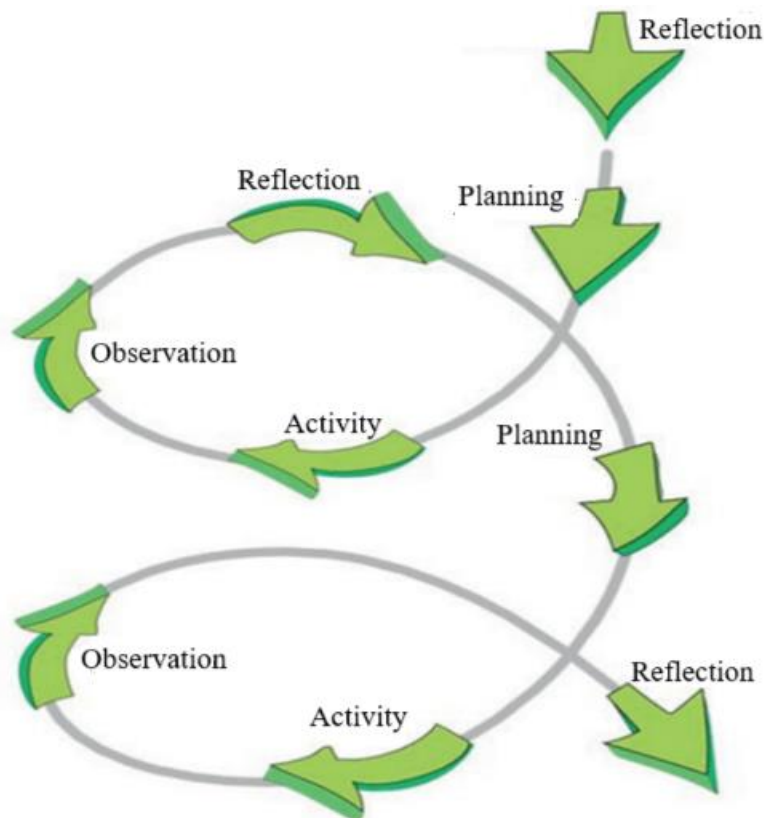


Fig. 1 Action research cycle spiral

Source: compiled by the authors according to Coghlan 2019, p. 9, cit. from Góral, A., Jałocha, B., Mazurkiewicz, G. & Zawadzki M. (2021). *Action Research A Handbook for Students*. Kraków: Instytut Spraw Publicznych UJ, p. 47.

The planning stage is about identifying the problem (topic), collecting information, conducting a literature review, and developing a research plan. The operational phase is about implementing the research plan, collecting data using observation, interview, document analysis, etc.

methods, and performing a data analysis. During the observation phase, the researcher assesses the implementation of the action plan. The reflection stage involves reflecting on the process and presenting the results (Adomaitienė, Zubrickienė, 2019). Reflection in action research refers to a deep reflection on one's own actions with the aim to adjust and improve them. The analysis and adjustment of one's own actions is based on constant reflection, which is important for improving professional activities (Adomaitienė and Zubrickienė, 2019). A reflection is self-awareness and consideration of the potential impact of one's values, world-view, and professional experience, and their influence on decisions and actions taken in the research process. Reflexivity indicates that researchers acknowledge and disclose their subjectivity and observe its potential impact on their data collection and data interpretation (Efrat and Ravid, 2013).

Research data collection. After identifying the research object, the researcher must decide on the method of collecting information. This can be done by applying qualitative and quantitative research methods: questionnaire, observation, interview, focus group discussion, case analysis, diaries, document analysis, etc. This can be achieved using various research instruments (questionnaire, survey, interview, observation, diary writing, reflection, observation protocol, etc.). The choice of the method depends on the chosen research object, issues, specific conditions, interests, attitudes, etc. (Adomaitienė and Zubrickienė, 2019; Efrat and Ravid, 2013).

Data analysis. The results of the study are presented taking into account the research methods – qualitative or quantitative data analysis – used in conducting the action study.

2.11. Determining the research sample and identifying the principles of research ethics

A detailed description of the research methods used is then followed by the information about the general population and the research sample. One of the necessary aspects of planning a research is defining the minimum sample in order to formulate conclusions that are statistically significant. The method of selecting an appropriate sample with the aim of identifying traits or characteristics common to the entire population is called sampling. Sampling is necessary because, due to financial and technical possibilities, rational calculation and logical justification, it is impractical to interview or study all elements of the population or general set of interest.

Samples are drawn in various ways, but there are two main sampling methods: probability and non-probability. In probability sampling, the probability of each element being included in the sample is known, while in non-probability sampling, the probability of selection is unknown.

The possible cases (methods) sampling are provided in Figure 1. More information about sample size and selection methods is available in the following sources: Rupšienė (2007, p. 7–35); Bilevičienė and Jonušauskas (2011, p. 26–33); Bryman (2016, p. 171–181).

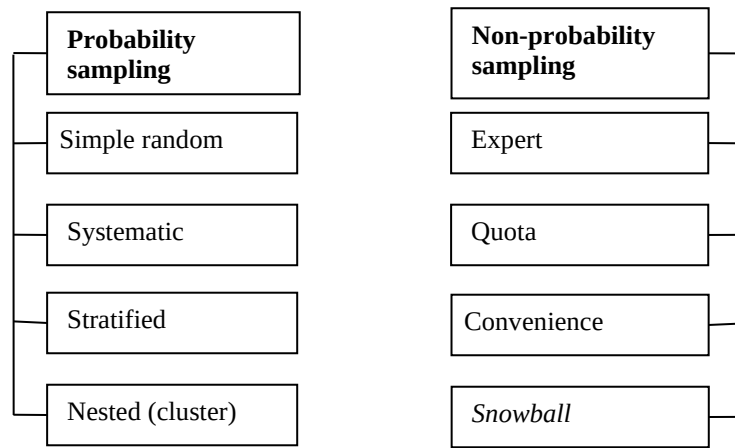


Fig. 2 Sampling cases

Source: Bilevičienė, T., Jonušauskas, S. (2011). *Statistinių metodų taikymas rinkos tyrimuose*. Vilnius, p. 29.

When organizing the sampling, it is necessary to determine the appropriate research margin of error is. It is most accurate to calculate the error only for probability samples. Non-probability sampling error is not calculated. In social research, 5 percent is considered a normal, standard error that is obtained with a probability of 0.95. The number of respondents is usually determined by using the Paniotto formula (Paniotto, Maksimenko, 1982, cited in Valackienė, 2004), which is adapted for calculations with a probability of 0.954:

$$n = \frac{1}{\Delta^2 + \frac{1}{N}}; \quad (1)$$

where: n – the necessary number of respondents;

Δ – error;

N – number of members of the population under study.

This formula (1) is proposed to be used to select the required sample of respondents under different errors ($\pm 5\%$, $\pm 7\%$, $\pm 10\%$) (see Tables 1, 2).

Table 1. Determining the sample of respondents when $N < 450$

Population size N	Sample size n under error Δ		
	$\pm 5\%$	$\pm 7\%$	$\pm 10\%$
100	81	67	51
125	96	78	56
150	110	86	61
175	122	94	64
200	134	101	67
225	144	107	70
250	154	112	72
275	163	117	74
300	172	121	76
325	180	125	77
350	187	129	78
375	194	132	80
400	201	135	81
425	207	138	82
450	212	140	82

Source: Kasnauskienė, G. (2010). *Statistika verslo sprendimams*. Vilnius, p. 290.

Table 2. Determining the sample of respondents when N is between 500 and 10,000

Population size N	Sample size n under error Δ		
	$\pm 5\%$	$\pm 7\%$	$\pm 10\%$
500	222	145	83
600	240	152	86
700	255	158	88
800	267	163	89
900	277	166	90
1 000	286	169	91
2 000	333	185	95
3 000	353	191	97
4 000	364	194	98
5 000	370	196	98
6 000	375	197	98
7 000	378	198	99
8 000	381	199	99
9 000	383	200	99
10 000	385	200	99

Source: Kasnauskienė, G. (2010). *Statistika verslo sprendimams*. Vilnius, p. 290.

The sample of respondents can also be determined online <<http://www.factus.lt/main-calculator/>>.

The main reasons for studying a sample rather than the entire population are: it saves money and time, some members of the population may not be available, some elements may have to be destroyed during the study, and accuracy – it is possible to isolate a smaller number of elements from a carefully selected sample with greater accuracy.

Minimum sample size when applying non-probability sampling methods for students:

- observation method – 5 respondents;
- interview method – 4-6 informants;
- written survey method – in case of one group of respondents – at least 60 respondents; in case of two groups of respondents (e.g. students and parents) – 60–80 respondents;
- sociometric research method – at least one group consisting of 5–11 people;
- experimental method – at least 5 respondents.

The researcher conducting the study should be guided by basic **ethical principles** and describe them in the research methodology description. He must inform the subject of the essence of the research, about possible risks, compliance with the ethical principles of the research, and obtain the subject's consent to participate in the research. The researcher must ensure the confidentiality, anonymity, and privacy of the information obtained about the subject. You can read more about research ethics in the following sources: Kardelis (2007, p. 76–84); Bitinas et al. (2008, part 1, p. 112–116,); Bryman (2016, p. 120–146).

This section describes the returnability of the written survey, i.e. how many questionnaires were distributed, how many were returned, and, if the study requires it, it is necessary to describe the

respondents' age, gender, social status or education, etc. The person conducting the research must indicate, which programs were used to analyse the data obtained (for example, Ms Excel, SPSS, etc.).

The end of the overview of the research methodology provides demographic data of the study participants.

It is recommended to search for information about research methodology, questionnaire design, data collection and processing, etc. in the following publications:

1. Adomaitienė, J. and Zubrickienė, I. (2019). *Veiklos tyrimai, jų taikymo teorija ir praktika*. Klaipėda: KU leidykla.
2. Bilevičienė, V. and Jonušauskas, T. (2011). *Statistinių metodų taikymas rinkos tyrimuose*. Vilnius: MRU.
3. Bitinas, B., Rupšienė, L., and Žydžiūnaitė, V. (2008). *Kokybinių tyrimų metodologija. Parts 1, 2*. Klaipėda: Saulius Jokužys Publishing & Printing House.
4. Bryman, A. (2016). *Social Research Methods*. New York: Oxford University Press.
5. Charles, C., M. (1999). *Pedagoginio tyrimo įvadas*. Vilnius: Alma Littera.
6. Efrat, S. & Ravid, R. (2013). *Action research in education: a practical guide*. New York: The Guilford Press. Access on the internet: https://www.daneshnamehicsa.ir/userfiles/files/1/9-%20Action%20Research%20in%20Education_%20A%20Practical%20Guide.pdf
7. Gaizauskaitė, I., Valavičienė, N. (2016). *Socialinių tyrimų metodai: kokybinis interviu*. Vilnius: Registrų centras.
8. Góral, A. Jałocha, B., Mazurkiewicz, G. & Zawadzki, M. (2021). *Action Research A Handbook for Students*. Kraków: Instytut Spraw Publicznych UJ.
9. Hamilton, L. (2011). Case studies in educational research. *British Educational Research Association*. BERA. Access on the internet: <https://www.bera.ac.uk/researchers-resources/publications/case-studies-in-educational-research>
10. Yazan, B. (2015). Three approaches to case study methods in education: Yin, Merriam, and Stake. *The Qualitative Report*, 20(2), 134–152. Access on the internet: <http://www.nova.edu/ssss/QR/QR20/2/yazan1.pdf>
11. Kara, H. (2015). *Creative Research Methods in the Social Sciences*. Bristol: Policy Press.
12. Kardelis, K. (2017). *Mokslinių tyrimų metodologija ir metodai*. Vilnius: Mokslo ir enciklopedijų leidyklos centras.
13. Kudinovienė, J. (2008). *Meno edukologinių tyrimų metodologijos pradmenys*. Vilnius: Vilniaus pedagogikos universitetas.
14. Morkevičius, V., Telešienė, A., & Žvaliauskas, G. (2008). *Kompiuterizuota kokybinių duomenų analizė su NVivo ir Text Analysis Suite. Pavyzdinis metodologinis mokomasis studijų*

paketas. Kaunas. Access on the internet: https://data.ktu.edu/wp-content/uploads/2023/06/Kompiuterizuota_kokybinio_duomeniu_analize.pdf

15. Naujanienė, R., Endriulaitienė, A., Ruškus, J., Gustainienė, L., Mažeikienė, N., Bukšnytė-Marmienė, L., Varžinskienė, L., Stelmokienė, A., Motiečienė, R., Genevičiūtė-Janonienė, G. and Jarašiūnaitė, G. (2016). *Veiklos tyrimas organizacijoje. Socialinių paslaugų senyvo amžiaus žmonėms atvejis*. Kaunas: Versu Aureus.

16. Norton L., S. (2009). *Action Research in Teaching and Learning. A practical guide to conducting pedagogical research in universities*. London and New York: Routledge

17. Rupšienė, L. (2007). *Kokybinio tyrimo duomenų rinkimo metodologija*. Klaipėda: Klaipėda University.

18. Sagor, R. (2005). *The action research guidebook: A four-step process for educators and school teams*. Thousand Oaks: Corwin Press.

19. Sirakaya-Turk E. and etc. (2017). *Research Methods for Leisure, Recreation and Tourism*. Wallingford: CABI.

20. Tidikis, R. (2003). *Socialinių mokslų tyrimų metodologija*. Vilnius: Lietuvos teisės universiteto Leidybos centras.

21. Valackienė, A. (2004). *Sociologinis tyrimas*. Kaunas: Technologija.

22. Valackienė, A. ir Mikėnė, S. (2010). *Sociologinis tyrimas. Metodologija ir atlikimo metodika*. Kaunas: Technologija.

23. Visuotinė lietuvių enciklopedija (2023). [accessed on 29 November 2023]. Access on the internet: <https://www.vle.lt/straipsnis/vieno-atvejo-tyrimo-metodas/>

24. Žydžiūnaitė, V. (2008). *Tyrimo dizainas: struktūra ir strategijos*. Kaunas: Technologija.

25. Žydžiūnaitė, V. (2011). *Baigiamojo darbo rengimo metodologija. Mokomoji knyga*. Klaipėda: Klaipėdos valstybinė kolegija | Higher Education Institution.

26. Žydžiūnaitė, V. and Sabaliauskas, S. (2017). *Kokybiniai tyrimai: principai ir metodai*. Vilnius: Vaga.

2.12. Practical part

The practical part of the work must be a research in nature, i.e. not limited to a description and presentation of research data, but rather a critical (evaluative) analysis of problems, research data, conclusions and proposals that have practical and applied value. The conclusions and suggestions in this part must be reasoned and based on the results of applied research and insights from theoretical analysis. It is recommended to formulate your conclusions and suggestions in a neutral grammatical form, for example, ...*determined*, ...*observed*, ...*suggested*, ...*proposed*, ...*recommended*, etc. Abstract suggestions ...*to strive*, ...*to aim*, ...*to improve*, ... *a better*, ...*more* are meaningless.

Tables and figures must be informative and neatly formatted. Each figure or table presented in the text must be commented on and the information provided in them must be analysed. However, it is not necessary to describe the content provided. If tables, graphs and other visual material presented occupy an entire A4 page, this material must be presented in annexes.

The summaries of the subsections of this part must highlight the empirical research analysis results. A correctly formulated summary shows whether the presented text answers the meaning of the title of the section (subsection).

Introductory and summary paragraphs may contain sentences that connect one part of the work to the previous or another part of the work. This creates the impression of continuity.

2.13. Conclusions and recommendations

The section of conclusions and recommendations present the results of the paper in a summarized and concentrated manner. This should not be a copy and paste of the conclusions and recommendations contained in the summaries of the analytical sections. Provide only the most important statements, illustrating the result of each of the task implemented. That is why the conclusions are numbered based on the research tasks. After presenting a conclusion that reveals the problem, a proposal(s) is formulated to solve the problem. The feasibility of each of the suggestions must be proved and reasoned in the practical part. Tasks, related to theory analysis are described in a single conclusion.

This part should not exceed 1-2 pages.

2.14. Literature

The bibliography is compiled at the end of a course paper, GPPS, or graduation paper on a new page in a separate section and under the heading *Literature*.

All sources must be provided in their original language. All sources of information in the bibliography must be listed in alphabetical order. The bibliography indicates books, articles, and documents that have been cited, discussed in one aspect or another, or commented on in the text. Sources printed in Latin characters – Lithuanian, English, German, French, other languages – are listed in alphabetical order first, followed by sources printed in Cyrillic or other characters. Bibliographic descriptions of scientific publications and other publications used (cited, paraphrased or mentioned) in the paper must also be arranged in alphabetical order according to international APA rules or the recommendations of the LST ISO 690:2010 standard. It is recommended to have at least one third of the literature resources by foreign authors, including half in a foreign language.

Textbooks can be used in exceptional cases, after reasoning the necessity for their use in the first section of the paper. A significant share of the list should consist of scientific resources (monographs, articles, scientific research data) in foreign languages. Other student papers (vocational bachelor's, bachelor's and master's papers) cannot be used or included into the list of literature. Literature that was read, but not used for the paper, does not need to be included into the list.

Information resources listed in the bibliography must not be numbered. Bibliography for course papers and GPPS must feature **at least 15** sources, while a graduation paper – **at least 25** information resources. At least two-thirds of the sources must be under ten years old.

Sample bibliography entries in the *Literature*:

Table 3. Sample bibliography entries

Type of resource	Bibliographic reference schemes for the list of literature	Sample bibliography entries
Book: 1 author	Surname, N. (year) <i>Book Title: Subtitle</i> . Place of publishing: Publishing House.	Vijeikis, J. (2014). <i>Demokratija ir ugdymas</i> . Klaipėda: UAB Baltic Printing House.
The book was released before	Surname, N. (year) <i>Book Title: Subtitle and short details of the issue in the brackets</i> . Place of publishing: Publishing House.	Aron, E. (2020). <i>Itin jautrus vaikas: kaip padėti mūsų vaikams gyvuoti, kai pasaulis juos stelbia</i> . (3rd rev. ed.). Vilnius: Sofoklis.
Book: 2 authors	Surname, N. and Surname, N. (year). <i>Book Title: Subtitle</i> . Place of publishing: Publishing House.	Kriščiūnas, B. and Dėdelė, A. (2014). <i>Aplinkos inžinerija</i> . Kaunas: Versus aureus.
Book: 3-5 authors	Surname, N., Surname N. and Surname, N. (year). <i>Book Title: Subtitle</i> . Place of publishing: Publishing House.	Žvirelienė, R., Žostautienė, D. and Kuvykaitė, R. (2014). <i>Prekės valdymas: pateiktys ir praktinės užduotys, 2nd reviewed and supplemented edition</i> . Kaunas: Technologija.
	Surname, N., Surname N., Surname, N., Surname, N., and Surname, N. (year). <i>Book Title: Subtitle</i> . Place of publishing: Publishing House.	Bajorūnienė, I. S., Kunigėlienė, D., Patašienė, I., Patašius, M. and Skvernys, V. (2011). <i>Verslo žaidimas: mokomoji knyga</i> . Kaunas: Technologija.
Book: 6-7 and more authors	Surname, N., Surname N., Surname, N., Surname, N., Surname, N., and Surname, N. (year). <i>Book Title: Subtitle</i> . Place of publishing: Publishing House.	Ambrasienė, D., Baranauskas, E., Bublėnė, D., Cirtautienė, S., Galvėnas, R., Laurinavičius, K., Norkūnas, A., Papirtis, L.V., Rudzinkas, A., Skibarkienė, Ž., Stripeikienė, J., Švirinas, D., Toločko, V. and Usonienė, J. (2006). <i>Civilinė teisė. Prievolių teisė: vadovėlis</i> . Vilnius: Mykolo Romerio universiteto Leidybos centras.
Book: a collective of authors	The collective of authors. (year). <i>Book Title: Subtitle</i> . Place of publishing: Publishing House.	Ministry of Education and Science of the Republic of Lithuania. (2016). <i>Lietuvos švietimas skaičiais: profesinis mokymas</i> . Vilnius: Education Supply Centre of the Ministry of Education and Science of the Republic of Lithuania.
A book without an author	<i>Book Title: Subtitle</i> . Place of publishing: Publishing House.	<i>Tarptautinių žodžių žodynas</i> (2013). Vilnius: Alma Littera.
Book: a part of a book (chapter, article)	Surname, N. (year). Title of the part of the book. From book author's N. Surname (ed.), <i>Book Title: Subtitle</i> (pages cited: p. 254-329). Place of publishing: Publishing House.	Valickas, A. (2012). Karjeros vystymas: organizacijos ir individo sąveika bei lūkesčių derinimas. From V., Gražulis, A., Valickas, R., Dačiulytė, T., Sudnickas. <i>Darbuotojas organizacijos koordinacinių sistemoje: žmogiškojo potencialo vystymosi perspektyvos: mokslo studija</i> (p. 254–329). Vilnius: Mykolas Romeris University.
	Surname, N. (year). Title of the part of the book. Book author's N. Surname (ed.), <i>Book Title: Subtitle</i> (pages cited: p. 254–329).	Matonytė, I. and Morkevičius, V. (2010). Threat perception and European identity building: the case of elites in Belgium, Germany, Lithuania and Poland. In G.

	p. 53-71). Place of publishing: Publishing House.	Ilonszki (Ed.), <i>Perceptions of the European Union in new member states: a comparative perspective</i> (53–71). London: Routledge.
E-book: with DOI	Surname, N. (year). <i>Book Title: Subtitle</i> . Place of publishing: Publishing House. https://doi:10.XX/XX .	Venckus, Z., (2008). <i>Aplinkos apsaugos politika ir teisė</i> (2nd reviewed ed.). Vilnius: Technika. https://doi.org/10.3846/900-s
E-book: without DOI	Surname, N. (year). <i>Book Title: Subtitle</i> . Place of publishing: Publishing House. Access on the internet: https://www.adress.lt	Barynienė, J., Sukackė, V., Ukvalbergienė, K., Daunorienė, A., Gudonienė, D. (2023). <i>Iššūkiams grįstas mokymasis: mokomoji knyga</i> . Kaunas: Technologija. Access on the internet: https://ebooks-ktu-edu.db.kvk.lt/pdfreader/ikiais-grstas-mokymasis
An article in a scientific journal: 1 author	Surname, N. (year). Article Title: Subtitle. <i>Journal Title</i> , volume No., (pages cited: p. 23–42).	Bučinskas, A. (2012). Investicija į vaikų sveikatą – svarbi žmoniškojo kapitalo kaupimo prielaida darnios plėtros kontekste. <i>Tiltai</i> 3, p. 213–230.
An article in a scientific journal: 2 authors	Surname, N. and Surname, N. (year). Article Title: Subtitle. <i>Journal Title</i> , volume No., (pages cited: p. 23–42).	Strazdienė, G. and Garalis, A. (2007). Studentų praktinio verslumo gebėjimų ugdymas imitacinėse įmonėse: verslo dėstytojų požiūris ir pedagoginės kompetencijos. <i>Mokytojų ugdymas</i> , No. 7, p. 72–91.
An article in a scientific journal: 3-5 authors	Surname, N., Surname N., Surname, N., and Surname, N. (year). Article Title: Subtitle. <i>Journal Title</i> , volume No., (pages cited: p. 23–42).	Stonienė, A., Martinkienė, J., Šakienė, H. and Romerytė-Šereikienė, R. (2009). Studentų kompetencijų tobulinimas verslo praktinio mokymo firmose. <i>Vadyba. Journal of Management</i> , Vol. 14, No. 2, p. 91–98.
Article in a scientific journal: 6-7 authors	Surname, N., Surname N., Surname, N., Surname, N., Surname, N., and last Surname, N. (year). Article Title: Subtitle. <i>Journal Title</i> , volume No., (pages cited: p. 23–42).	Snyder, T., Banac, I., Kopeček, M., Aleksandravičius, E., Portnov, A., Ungvary, K., & Borodziej, W. (2010). Politics of history in eastern Europe. <i>Journal of Modern European History</i> , 8(2), p. 141–163.
Article in a scientific journal online, when there is no author	Article Title: Subtitle. (Year, month, day) <i>Journal Title</i> , volume No., (pages cited: p. 23–42).	As prices surge, Thailand pitches OPEC-style rice cartel. (5 May 2008). <i>The Wall Street journal</i> , p. 9–13.
Electronic article with DOI	Surname, N. (year). Article Title: Subtitle. <i>Journal Title</i> , volume No., (pages cited: p. 23–42), https://doi:10.XX/XX .	Gorlevskaya, L. (2016). Building effective marketing communications in tourism. <i>Studia Commercialia Bratislavensia</i> , 9(35), p. 252–265, https://doi.org/10.1515/stcb-2016-0025
Electronic article without DOI	Surname, N. (year). Article Title: Subtitle. <i>Journal Title</i> , volume No., (pages cited: p. 23–42). Access on the internet: http://www.adress.lt	Saeed, R. (2013). Integrated marketing communication: a review paper. <i>Interdisciplinary journal of contemporary research in business</i> . Vol. 5, No. 5, p. 124–133. Access on the internet: http://journal-archives35.webs.com/124-133.pdf
Article in a daily or weekly publication	Surname, N. (year, month, day). Article Title: Subtitle. <i>Title of the Daily</i> , pages.	Laurinkus, M. (8 May 2010). Be kaukės. <i>Lietuvos rytas</i> , p. 4.
Article in a daily or weekly publication online	Surname, N. (year, month, day). Article Title: Subtitle. <i>Title of the Daily</i> . [Accessed on DD/MM/YYYY]. Access on the internet: http://www.adress.lt	Vaičiūnas, Ž. (18 July 2017). Lietuvos energetika 2050 m.: saugus ir patikimas tiekimas, žaliąji energetika ir inovacijos. <i>Veidas</i> . [accessed on 10 December 2017]. Access on the internet: http://www.veidas.lt/lietuvos-energetika-2050-m-saugus-ir-patikimas-tiekimas-zalioji-energija-ir-inovacijos
Article from an encyclopaedia		Visuotinė lietuvių enciklopedija (2018). <i>Lietuvos mokesčių sistema</i> . [accessed on 24 May 2018]. Access on the internet: https://www.vle.lt/Straipsnis/Lietuvos-mokesciu-sistema-117662
Website	Surname, N. (year). <i>Website/document title</i> . [Accessed on DD/MM/YYYY]. Access on the internet: http://www.adress.lt	Rimkutė, D. (2013). <i>Atsargiai, galite užsikrėsti nuotaika</i> . [accessed on 24 May 2018]. Access on the internet: http://www.psichologijatau.lt/atsargiai-galite-uzsikresti-nuotaika/ .

	Title of a collective of authors. (year). <i>Website/document title</i> . [Accessed on DD/MM/YYYY]. Access on the internet: http://www.adress.lt	Library of Klaipėdos valstybinė kolegija Higher Education Institution. (2018). <i>Publikacijų paieška</i> . [accessed on 24 May 2018]. Access on the internet: https://www.kvk.lt/lt/publikaciju-paieska/ .
	Institution/editor title. (year). <i>Title of a website article/document</i> . [Accessed on DD/MM/YYYY]. Access on the internet: http://www.adress.lt	Ministry of Education, Science and Sport of the Republic of Lithuania. (2021). <i>Išankstines sutartis dėl darbo po studijų sudarę būsimi mokytojai gali gauti 500 Eur per mėnesį stipendijas</i> . [accessed on 25 September 2022]. Access on the internet: https://smsm.lrv.lt/lt/naujienos/isankstines-sutartis-del-darbo-po-studiju-sudare-busimi-mokytojai-gali-gauti-500-eur-per-menesi-stipendijas .
Doctoral dissertation	Surname, N. (year). <i>Dissertation Title: Subtitle</i> (type of resource). Title of the academic institution. [Accessed on DD/MM/YYYY]. Access on the internet: http://www.adress.lt	Paliukėnaitė, V. (2015). <i>Regioninės inovacijų sistemos absorbcinio gebėjimo vystymas: daktaro disertacija</i> (manuscript). Kaunas University of Technology. [accessed on 22 May 2018]. Access on the internet: http://talpykla.elaba.lt/elaba-fedora/objects/elaba:6941285/datastreams/MAIN/content
Legal acts		Parliament of the Republic of Lithuania. <i>Law on Higher Education and Research</i> (30 April 2009, No. XI-242). [accessed on 28 April 2018]. Access on the internet: https://www.e-tar.lt/portal/lt/legalAct/TAR.C595FF45F869
Reciting. The original source is inaccessible, so the text must indicate that the author is using a secondary source.	The literature list must include the secondary source.	Krasauskaitė, S. (2004). Įmonės įvaizdžio modelis. <i>Reklamos ir marketingo idėjos</i> . No.1., p. 68–70.
Patent		Baltrėnas, P., ir Buckus, R. (2014). <i>Mobilių telefono dėklas: patentas</i> . State Patent Bureau of the Republic of Lithuania

If the literature list includes several works by the same author, they must be listed chronologically according to their release date, starting from the latest, for example: 2024, 2019, 2018, etc.

In case of any questions, more information is available here:

<https://apastyle.apa.org/instructional-aids/reference-examples.pdf>.

2.15. Annexes

The annexes contain other relevant additional material prepared independently by the student: statistical data, visual material, primary data from conducted research, and other material, used for calculations, conclusions, and analysis performed in the paper.

All annexes must be numbered and have a corresponding reference in the text of the course paper, GPPS, or graduation paper. The annexes are numbered according to their use in the text.

If tables, graphs and other visual material presented in the main parts of the paper occupy an entire A4 page, they must be provided in a smaller font or in annexes.

Each individual annex begins on a new page.

If an annex consists of several pages, then the second and further pages must indicate that this is a continuation.

The title of the course paper, GPPS, or graduation paper and annex number are indicated in the upper right margin, in pt. 10.

3. PAPER FORMATTING

Formatting requirements for course papers, GPPS, graduation, and other papers:

- Course papers, GPPS, and graduation papers are written in Lithuanian language. In individual cases, i.e. when studying in a foreign language, and studying in joint study programs, graduation papers may be written in a foreign language. Students must use coherent and correct language, evading mistakes and using proper formatting.

- The length of course papers and GPPS (without annexes) is 25-30 pages, the length of a graduation paper (without annexes) is 40-50 pages. The length of the theoretical part should not exceed the practical part. If the graduation paper is written by 2 students, the length of the paper must be 60-80 pages, annexes not included.

- The paper must be printed one-sided on A4 (210 x 297 mm) white pages.
- Graduation, course paper, and GPPS margins: top and bottom – 2 cm, left – 3 cm, right – 1 cm.

- The first line of each paragraph must be offset from the left margin by 1,5 cm.
- All paragraphs must be aligned according to left and right margins (justified).
- Text font – 12 pt, *Times New Roman*.
- The header contains the author's name and surname (on the left side) and the title of the paper (on the right side). The footer (on the left) title of college and year. The font of the page header and footer is 10 pt *Times New Roman* (grey) and the text must be separated from the main text of the paper with a thin (1/2 pt grey) solid line.

- Pages (except the title page) are numbered in Arabic numerals in the middle of the footer, without periods or commas, 12 pt font.

- Chapter titles are written in bold uppercase, subsection titles – written in bold sentence case letters, *Times New Roman*, 12 pt.

- The text of the graduation paper must be formatted with 1,5 line spacing (single line spacing for tables and figures).

- Space between titles and text – 1 blank line.
- Parts of the work (sections and subsections) are numbered consecutively in Arabic numerals.

- Parts 1, 2 and 3 of the course paper, GPPS, and final thesis begin on a new page.

- The title page must be formatted according to the requirements of Annex 7 (graduation paper) or Annex 6 (course paper). It must contain precise details. Font size – 12 pt. Graduation or course paper titles are written in uppercase letters. College title and theme on the title page must be written in bold.

- All tables and figures must have titles and numbers. Tables and figures are numbered the same throughout the paper using plain Arabic numerals. The text in tables must be printed in 10 pt font, with single line spacing. Text in figures can also be written in *Times New Roman* 10-12 pt.

- Table titles are written above the table in the centre, and figure titles are written below the figure in the centre in a 12 pt font, with single line spacing. Sources are printed in 10 pt font, centred. If a table or figure was compiled by the author of the course paper, GPPS, or graduation paper, the source is indicated as follows:

Source: compiled by the author according to the data of Statistics Lithuania 2021.

- Sources of illustrations by other authors should be provided as follows:

Source: Dubinas, V. and Smilga, E. (2008). Strateginio valdymo panaudojimo galimybės Lietuvoje. *Organizacijų vadyba: sisteminiai tyrimai*. Kaunas, p. 25.

- When using a complete table or figure published in another source, it is necessary to indicate the original source below. If a table or figure from another source is difficult to translate or depict, its original copy may be placed in the annexes.

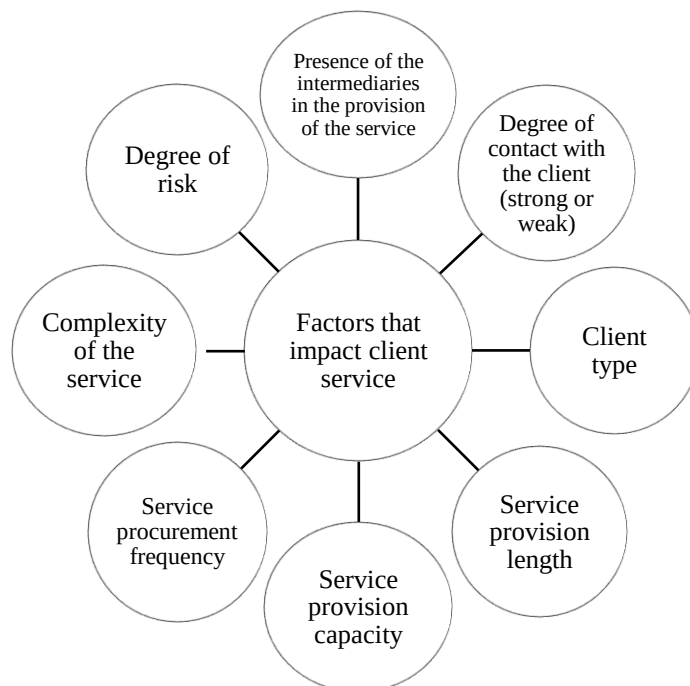


Fig. 3 Factors that impact client service

Source: compiled by the author according to Bagdonienė, L., Hopenienė, R. (2015). *Paslaugų marketingas ir vadyba*. Kaunas, p. 45; Pranulis, V. et al. (2012). *Marketing*. Vilnius, p. 63.

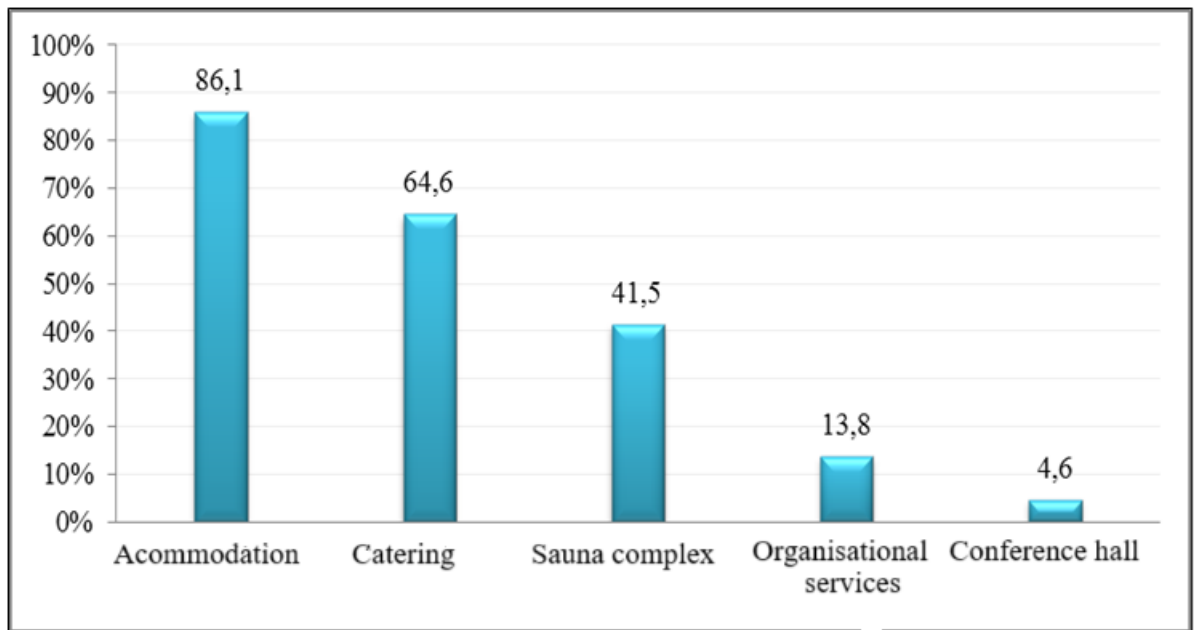


Fig. 4 Choice of hospitality services

Source: compiled by the author according to research data, 2021

Table 4. Concept of management styles

Authors	Concepts
Lam, O'Higgins (2012, cit. from Petrulis, 2017)	Leadership traits are particularly important when assessing leadership style.
Cooper (2016, cit. from Petrulis, 2017)	Leadership style can be described as a combination of a person's traits, skills, and behaviours.
Bhat et al. (2012, cit. from Petrulis, 2017)	A leadership style is regarded as actions used by the manager to influence employee behaviour, make goal-oriented or employee-oriented decisions, and maintain a balance between the goal being pursued and attention to employees.
Sudha, Shahnawaz, Farhat (2016, cit. from Petrulis, 2017)	A leadership style is the most important factor which determines effectiveness
Nagendra, Farooqui (2016, cit. from Petrulis, 2017)	A leadership style is regarded as a combination of traits, characteristics, abilities and behaviours, applied by managers interacting with their employees.

Source: Petrulis, A. (2017). Darbuotojams priimtinausias vadovavimo stilius organizacijoje. *Regional Formation and Development Studies*, No. 1 (21). Klaipėda, p. 109.

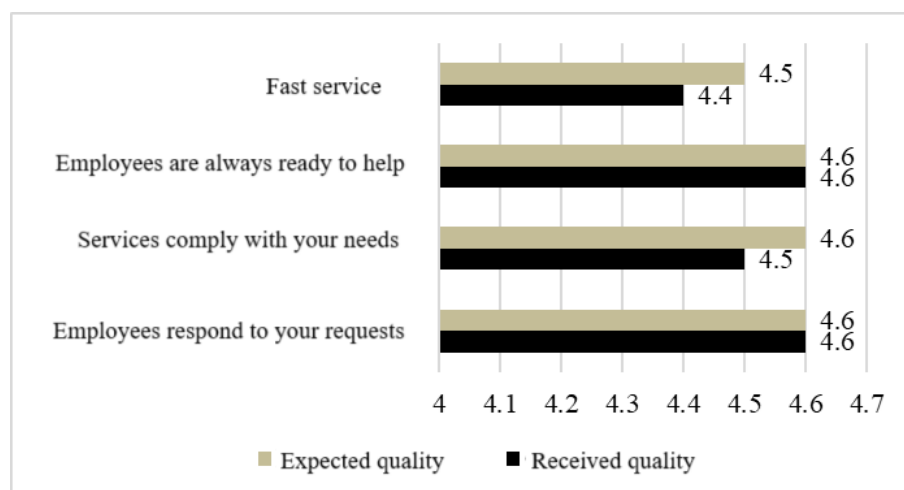


Fig. 5 Distribution of respondents by response quality criterion

Source: compiled by the author according to research data, 2021.

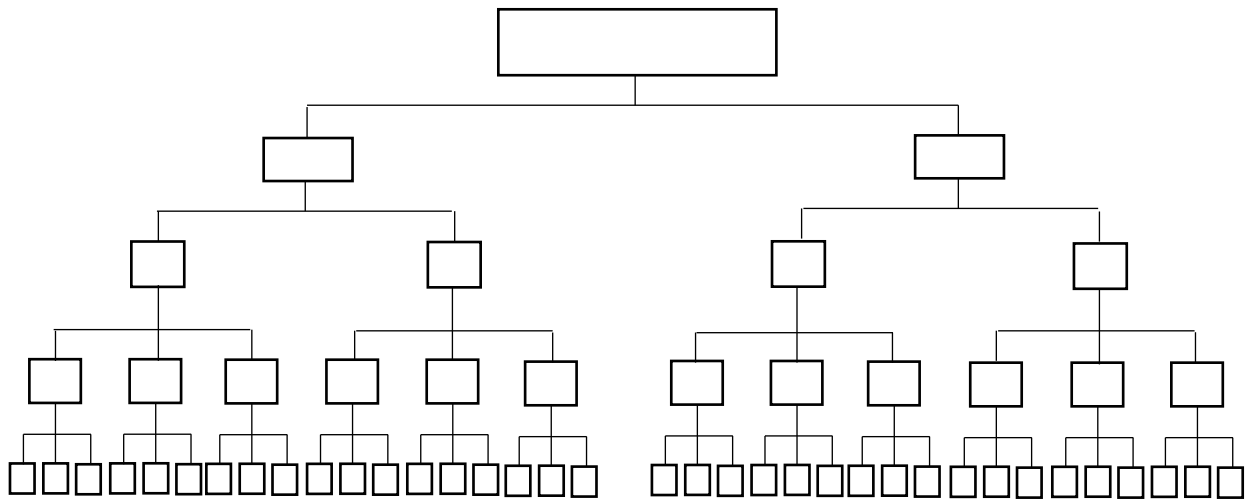


Fig. 6 High organisational structure

Source: Vanagas, R., Vyšniauskienė, L. (2012). *Vadybos pagrindai: vadovėlis*. Vilnius, p. 116.

Table 5. Inventory management indices

No.	Index	2020	2021	2022	2023	2024
1.	Average inventory size, tonnes	3860.1	5477.6	4040.9	3420.4	3180.4
2.	Alternative inventory costs, Eur	219064.1	318918.4	289628.7	200316.2	193061.8
3.	Inventory costs per one litas of average inventory	0.33	0.29	0.29	0.25	0.24
4.	Annual inventory ordering costs, Eur	3644930	3876920	3701206	3635280	3620250
5.	Annual total inventory ordering costs, Eur	4134116.3	4515093.6	4211838.9	3990976.2	3925349.5
6.	Economic order size, tonnes	21073.6	27001.9	21758.1	21869.2	21910.8
7.	Volume discount economy	-	-	-	-	-
8.	Volume discount value	-	-	-	-	-
9.	New inventory order placement point, days	0.46	0.44	0.46	0.47	0.48

Source: compiled by the author according to the production company's financial reporting data for 2010-2014.

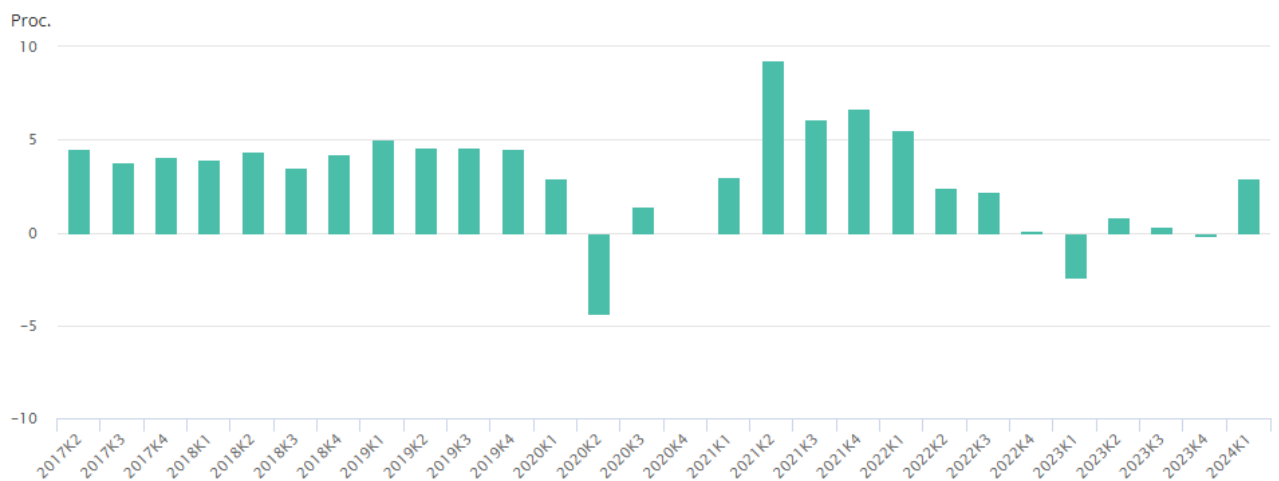


Fig. 7 Changes in gross domestic product compared to the corresponding quarter of the previous year

Source: Oficialios statistikos portalas. <https://osp.stat.gov.lt/lietuvos-ekonomikos-raida/ukis-ir-finansai>.

- Date writing: calendar dates in Lithuanian language are written in *numerical format* without dots and with hyphens, dividing the year, month and day, for example:

2022-05-10

When writing a date in digital form with hyphens in the *Ms Word* text editor, to avoid the date being broken, use the shortcut keys Ctrl + Shift + hyphen.

- or mixed format:

5 June 2022.

- If a quotation is set off in quotation marks or italics due to its significance it must fully correspond to the original text: punctuation, paragraphs, spacing, underlining. Only individual word or sentence outtakes are allowed. In the middle or at the end of quotations, they are indicated by a bracket ellipsis [...]. An outtake at the beginning of a sentence is indicated with an ellipsis only.

- Various measurement units are indicated as abbreviations in text (for example, 18 pct.) and symbols in graphs and tables. If, when writing abbreviations (35 percent, 5 June, etc.), part of the text remains on one line, and another part moves to a new one, it is suggested to insert a non-break space between them using the shortcut keys CTRL + SHIFT + space.

- Formulas are written using the Equation application provided with Microsoft Word (Insert→ Symbols→ Equation). If formulas are used in the text and there is more than one of them, they must be numbered. The numbering must be indicated immediately after the formulas, in brackets, closer to the right edge of the sheet. The formula is followed by a semicolon and the symbols are explained on the next line. The text or formula must include a reference to the source from which it was taken or by whom it was compiled, for example, The capacity of logistics centres must be assessed as follows (Paulauskas, 2005):

$$N_T = K_1 \cdot N_a + K_2 \cdot N_g + K_3 \cdot N_v \quad (2)$$

where: K_i – coefficients of the value of each transport system; their total sum must be equal to one;

N_a – road transport infrastructure capacity;

N_g – railway transport capacity;

N_v – water transport capacity;

- If the graduation paper contains any special symbols or characters, which cannot be written or typed using a computer, they can be included by hand.

- Annexes have no page numbering.

4. GRADUATION PAPER DEFENCE

4.1. Preparation for the defence of the graduation paper

For the public defence of the graduation papers, the director issues an order to form a qualification commission with a chairman, based on recommendations of the dean of the faculty. The commission must consist of at least 3 (5) members, unless the Description of the studies provides otherwise. Graduation papers can be defended by students, who have completed all requirements, established in the study programme.

The graduation paper review takes place at the department no later than 14 calendar days prior the beginning of the public defence. It is attended by graduation paper advisers, students, and the head of the department. The review can also be attended by other interested persons (lecturers, students, social partners). The purpose of the graduation paper review is to review the work and listen to the student's presentation of the graduation paper, to assess whether all mandatory requirements for the structure, content, scope and format of the final thesis have been met, and to give recommendations of what should be corrected. The graduation paper advisers and the head of the department review the graduation papers, offering recommendations to make the graduation paper suitable for defence by the qualification committee.

Students must upload a properly written graduation paper on Moodle and agree to have the graduation paper checked by the Turnitin plagiarism checking system 3 working days prior to the review at the department. The author uploading the paper is responsible for its content and authenticity. A graduation paper that has not been uploaded on Moodle and checked for plagiarism and will not be evaluated or allowed to be submitted for review at the department.

Before the review of the graduation paper at the department, the graduation paper adviser must become familiar with the graduation paper checking and verification report on Moodle and *Turnitin* plugin. Before making a decision regarding the graduation paper review at the department, the advisor must review the graduation final project plagiarism checker report. The total percentage of overlap, which is considered plagiarism, must not exceed 20 percent (7 percent with a single source). A paper may be considered unoriginal if the overall overlap with other sources (with and/or without citing the source) accounts for more than 50 percent of the entire content. In such a case, the graduation paper supervisor provides the head of the department with a decision to refuse to allow the public defence of the graduation paper. Students are informed of the decision to allow or not to allow access to public defence during the review at the department.

The content of graduation papers that were recognised by the department meeting as suitable for public defence may be amended until the final submission for evaluation (public defence) at the

meeting of the qualification commission. Changes must be coordinated with the graduation paper adviser.

Students must submit at least one printed copy of the graduation paper for public defence and upload the electronic version to the eLABA system. The submission of the graduation paper is registered in the graduation paper registration journal.

When the final version of the graduation paper is uploaded on the *Turnitin* peer review system, the graduation paper adviser performs a peer review of the graduation paper once again and approves it for defence. A graduation paper is allowed to be publicly defended if it does not contain instances of text overlap that could be interpreted as plagiarism (the *Turnitin* system does not determine whether a thesis is plagiarized; this can be determined only by the graduation paper adviser based on the information on the detected overlaps provided). The graduation paper adviser must submit written feedback on the graduation paper submitted (Annex 10) to the department no later than 2 working days before the public defence. The graduation paper adviser offers their opinion on the paper, but does not grade it.

The student has the right to become familiar with the questions raised by the graduation paper reviewer at the department no later than one working day before the meeting of the graduation paper evaluation committee.

Permission to defend the graduation paper is certified upon the recommendation of the dean of the faculty by the order of the director no later than 6 working days before the meeting of the graduation paper evaluation committee.

4.2. Public defence of the graduation paper

The graduation paper defence dates are announced no later than 30 calendar days until the beginning of the public defence. The defence of the graduation paper takes place at the meeting of the qualification commission, appointed by the order of the director.

The public meeting of the graduation paper defence qualification commission takes place in Lithuanian language. In cases, when the graduation paper is submitted in English language or when the participants of the meeting use English language, it may be translated into Lithuanian.

In individual cases, at the student's request, upon the recommendation of the head of the department and by the order of the dean, the graduation paper may be defended remotely. Students must submit their applications to defend the graduation paper remotely to the head of the department. Upon receiving a student's request to defend the thesis remotely, the head of the department discusses the case with the dean of the faculty. Upon receiving an approval of the dean of the faculty, the department head will inform the student and the qualification commission that the paper will be

defended remotely. The suitability of the technical equipment and internet connection must be ensured by a responsible employee, appointed by the dean of the faculty.

During the public defence, the chair of the qualification commission invites the author of the graduation paper, reads the title of the paper, introduces the advisor, and then gives the word to the student.

The author(s) of the graduation paper briefly introduce(s) the graduation paper, indicating the research problem, goal, objectives, object, methodology of the research, results obtained, conclusions and recommendations. The defence of the graduation paper takes 7-10 min.

It is recommended to use *Power Point* and other applications during the course paper, GPPS, or graduation paper presentation. The recommended number of slides is 10-12.

The recommended order of the slides, of the course paper, GPPS, or graduation paper presentation should be as follows:

- first slide – titles of the university, faculty, study programme, name and surname of the author, and title of the graduation paper;
- second slide – research problem and research object;
- third slide – research purpose and research tasks;
- fourth slide – research methodology;
- the fifth and subsequent slides should describe the research task and results obtained in tables or graphs. A maximum of two slides are recommended for each task;
- The final slides present summaries, conclusions, and suggestions.

Tips for the paper presentation:

- the presentation can be prepared using a slide template approved by KVK (<https://moodle.kvk.lt/>); a template supplemented with the symbols of the organization where the research was conducted; another subject-specific template;
- the design of all slides should be uniform, with the same background and font size;
- Each slide must contain a title, for example, *research problem, object and purpose of the research, tasks*, etc. – this will make it clear for the listener what parameter is being presented;
- the slides contain individual, bulleted statements (each slide should contain only essential information with the student providing more details by commenting each slide);
- one slide consists of 7–8 lines of text; text font size – 24-28 pt (headings – 32 pt);
- Information can be presented in graphs, tables, schemes, figures (the text is provided orally, while the audience is looking at the illustration);
- Animations should be modest and using sound effects is unrecommended.

After the presentation of the graduation paper, the committee secretary reads the reviewer's

feedback and presents the reviewer's questions that must be answered by the student. After that, the student may be asked questions by members of the qualification commission and, with the permission of the chairperson of the qualification committee, by other persons participating in the public defence.

When presenting the work at the qualification commission's meeting, the student should:

- follow the rules of business attire;
- greet the audience and introduce himself/herself;
- speak clearly and loud enough;
- use a confident tone;
- stand facing and communicating with the audience;
- stay calm or refrain from showing that he/she is nervous;
- if needed – ask to repeat the question;
- refrain from showing irritation upon receiving a critical comment, giving a respectful answer instead;
- answers to questions given by the reviewer and committee members during the defence must be ethical, based on the steps of the research process, the results of the research, and the conclusions obtained.

The meetings of the qualification commission are recorded both in audio and minutes, and the records are stored. The secretary of the qualification commission submits the protocols of the defence of the graduation papers, reviews, and adviser feedback to the Department no later than 2 working days after the defence.

Students that have not arrived to their graduation paper defence for a justifiable reason may be allowed to defend their graduation paper during another qualification commission meeting of the same study programme.

Students, who have not completed their course paper or GPPS before the deadline, have not arrived to the defence of their course paper or GPPS without a valid reason, have not defended it or have not participated in the defence at all, receive an academic debt.

After the public defence of the graduation paper, the head of the department submits the list of graduation papers defended at the meeting of the qualification commission with evaluations to the senior librarian of KVK academic department, indicating the access status of their storage in the eLABa system.

The authors of the graduation paper must organize all the technical graduation paper metadata and confirm the defence of the graduation paper within 3 working days after the public defence.

Graduation papers that were evaluated by the qualification committee as excellent or very good may be made publicly available (if they do not contain any classified data); other graduation papers are available only on the institution's intranet.

4.3. Evaluation

Graduation paper evaluation. The graduation paper is evaluated by a qualification reviewer and a committee. The graduation paper is submitted to the department for a review no later than 5 working days before the meeting of the qualification commission. The exact date is determined by the head of the department, where the student is defending the graduation paper. The reviewer must objectively identify the strengths and weaknesses of the graduation paper, assess its compliance with the formal requirements specified in this methodology, and present questions to the author, which he or she will have to answer during the public defence. The reviewer evaluates the work on a ten-point scale. The reviewer must submit the graduation paper evaluation (Annex 13) to the department no later than two working days before the date of the qualification committee meeting. The student has the right to become familiar with the evaluation of the graduation paper reviewer at the department no later than one working day before the meeting of the qualification committee.

The graduation paper adviser's comment (Annex 10) must be submitted to the department no later than two working days before the public defence. The graduation paper adviser offers their opinion on the paper, but does not grade it.

The qualification commission is formed each year by the order of KVK Director, upon the recommendation of the Dean of the Faculty, to evaluate the study results achieved by students of individual study programmes. The minimum number of commission members is 3 (5), unless the study field description provides otherwise. The commission consists of one representative of the organization, who is appointed as the chairman of the commission (whose qualifications correspond to the field of study program), a scientist or a lecturer from another higher education institution, and a lecturer from this study program. The composition of the qualification commission must comply with the requirements of the study field descriptions.

The qualification commission is formed one month before the public defence.

The graduation papers are evaluated after the public defence at a closed meeting of the qualification committee, which is recorded in minutes. Only members of the qualification commission participate in the closed meeting and have the right to vote.

The graduation papers are evaluated unanimously on a ten-point grading scale.

Members of the qualification committee evaluate the graduation paper based on its compliance with formal requirements, correct use of the Lithuanian language, demonstrated level of achievement of the study programme results, and presentation of the graduation paper. The evaluation

of the graduation paper by the qualification commission is equal to the arithmetic average of the evaluations of all commission members, rounded to a whole number. The final grade of the graduation paper includes the reviewer's evaluation, whose grade weighting coefficient is 0.2, and the evaluation of the qualification commission, whose grade weighting coefficient is 0.8. In an event of a dispute regarding the evaluation, the final decision is made by the chairman of the commission. The graduation paper is considered defended if it receives an evaluation of at least 5 points.

The decision of the graduation paper qualification commission is approved in a closed meeting by a protocol signed by the chairman of the qualification commission. The evaluation of the graduation paper is recorded in the minutes of the qualification commission meeting and entered into the final grade summary, which is used to prepare the higher education diploma supplement.

The decision on the evaluation of the graduation paper is made at a closed meeting of the qualification committee. The evaluation of the graduation paper is recorded in the evaluation sheet of the Study Management Information System.

The decision of the qualification commission is final; appeals regarding the evaluation of graduation papers are not considered. They may be submitted on behalf of the director regarding procedural violations within 24 hours of the announcement of the graduation paper evaluation results.

If the grade of the graduation paper is unsatisfactory, the student, having improved it, may defend it again no earlier than after six months, but no later than after two years.

Course paper evaluation. The course paper must be submitted to the department for the evaluation at the time specified in the course paper writing plan.

Course papers, written as an individual subject of the study programme, are evaluated by a commission of the department, consisting of course paper advisers and other lecturers working with the study programme. The course paper adviser must submit the course paper evaluation (Annex 13) prior to the course paper defence. During the defence of the course papers, the commission objectively determines the strong and weak aspects of each course paper and evaluates their compliance with the requirements specified in this methodology. When the course paper is integrated into a study subject, the course paper is evaluated by the adviser (Annex 13). The course paper is considered defended if it receives an evaluation of at least 5 points. Course paper evaluations are recorded in the Study management information system evaluation sheet by the head of the department.

Students, who fail to submit the course paper on time get an academic debt, which can be eliminated according to the principles of KVK study achievement assessment procedure.

Evaluation of graduation papers for pedagogical studies. The graduation papers for pedagogical studies must be submitted to the department for the evaluation at the time specified in the GPPS writing plan.

The graduation papers for pedagogical studies are evaluated by a commission formed at the department, consisting of GPPS advisers and lecturers teaching other study programmes. The GPPS adviser must submit the GPPS evaluation (Annex 13) prior to the GPPS defence. During the GPPS defence, the commission objectively determines the strong and weak aspects of each paper and evaluates their compliance with the requirements specified in this methodology. The GPPS is considered defended if it receives an evaluation of at least 5 points. GPPS evaluations are recorded in the Study management information system evaluation sheet by the head of the department.

Students, who fail to submit their papers on time get an academic debt, which can be eliminated according to the principles of KVK study achievement assessment procedure.

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FACULTY TITLE

DEPARTMENT TITLE

STUDY PROGRAMME TITLE

SAMPLE COURSE PAPER / GPPS WRITING PLAN

Student name, surname _____

Group, phone number, e-mail address _____

Course paper / GPPS title _____

No.	Title of the activity	Planned date	Comment and signature of the graduation paper advisor, date	Student signature
1.	Discussion of the paper structure (content)			
2.	Introduction			
3.	Theoretical part (section)			
4.	Research methodology			
5.	Practical research part			
6.	Other compulsory parts of the paper (conclusions and recommendations, literature, annexes, summary, etc.)			
7.	Submission of the paper to the advisor and presentation during the public defence			
8.	GP overlap check (<i>Turnitin</i>)			
9.	Uploading graduation paper into the Lithuanian Academic Electronic Library eLABa			

Notes _____

Course paper / GPPS adviser _____

(name, surname, signature)

Course paper / GPPS consultant _____

(name, surname, signature)

Department Head _____

(name, surname, signature)



FACULTY TITLE

DEPARTMENT TITLE

STUDY PROGRAMME TITLE

GRADUATION PAPER WRITING PLAN

Student name, surname _____

Group, phone number, e-mail address _____

Graduation paper topic title _____

No.	Title of the activity	Planned date	Comment and signature of the graduation paper advisor, date	Student signature
1.	Discussion of the graduation paper structure			
2.				
...				
...	Graduation paper preparation and submission to the advisor			
...	GP overlap check (<i>Turnitin</i>)			
...	Uploading graduation paper into the Lithuanian Academic Electronic Library eLABa			

Notes _____

GP adviser _____

(name, surname, signature)

GP consultant _____

(name, surname, signature)

Department Head _____

(name, surname, signature)

(Company title, details)

To Klaipėdos valstybinė kolegija | Higher Education Institution

STATEMENT REGARDING THE USE OF AN ORGANISATION’S NAME AND DETAILS

(date, No.)

The student _____
writing their graduation paper _____
can use the title of and all data related to _____
_____ .

This graduation paper is an applied research, and the suggestions provided therein will be used for the improvement of the organisation’s activities.

(position, L.S.)

(signature)

(N. Surname)

(Student name, surname, title of the study programme, group)

(place of residence, phone)

Title of the educational institution

REQUEST TO CONDUCT AN APPLIED RESEARCH

(date)
Klaipėda

I hereby request to conduct an applied research for the graduation paper of the pedagogical studies on the topic

The data collected will remain confidential. The results obtained will be shared.

(signature)

(student name, surname)

I agree

(position)

(signature)

(name, surname)

L. S.

(Student name, surname, title of the study programme, group)

(place of residence, phone)

Title of the organisation

REQUEST TO CONDUCT AN APPLIED RESEARCH

(date)
Klaipėda

I hereby request for a permission to conduct an applied research for my course paper /
graduation paper (delete the unnecessary) on the topic of _____

The data collected will remain confidential. The results obtained will be shared.

(signature)

(student name, surname)

I agree

(position)

(signature)

(name, surname)

L. S.



FACULTY OF BUSINESS
DEPARTMENT OF XX

TITLE OF THE COURSE PAPER / GPPS

Course paper / Graduation paper for pedagogical studies

Author (student name, surname)

(signature)

(date)

Adviser (position, academic degree, name, surname)

(signature)

(date)

Klaipėda, 2024



FACULTY TITLE
DEPARTMENT TITLE

TITLE OF THE GRADUATION PAPER

Professional bachelor's graduation paper

Title of the study programme

State code of the study programme (*indicate*)

Title of the field of studies

Author (student name, surname)

(signature)

(date)

Adviser (position, academic degree, name, surname)

(signature)

(date)

Sample table of contents of a graduation paper:

Content

List of tables	3
List of figures	4
Concept vocabulary	5
Summary in Lithuanian language.....	6
Summary in English language	7
Introduction	8
1. THEORETICAL ANALYSIS OF WAREHOUSE MANAGEMENT IMPROVEMENT	9
1.1. Features and problems of managing manufacturing enterprises and their divisions.....	9
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Annex No. 3. UAB Konservų aibė organizational management structure chart

Annex No. 4. UAB Konservų aibė warehouse floor plan

Sample summary page

Santrauka

Vardenis Pavardenis „(BD pavadinimas)_____“,

_____ **studijų programa, Verslo fakultetas, Klaipėdos valstybinė kolegija.**

Tyrimo problema. Tekstas tekstas tekstas.

Tyrimo objektas – tekstas tekstas tekstas.

Tyrimo tikslas – tekstas tekstas tekstas.

Tyrimo metodai: tekstas tekstas tekstas.

Išvados ir pasiūlymai. Tekstas tekstas tekstas.

Raktiniai žodžiai: tekstas, tekstas, tekstas.

Summary

Name Surname (Title of Graduation Paper or Final Project)_____“,

_____ **Study Programme, Faculty of Business, Klaipėdos valstybinė kolegija | Higher
education institution.**

Research problem. Text text text.

Research object – text text text.

Research aim – text text text.

Research methods: text text text.

Conclusions. Text text text.

Key words: text, text, text.

Sample interview protocol.

Interview protocol No. 5

Interview date: 11/11/2023

Interview time: 14:00:00

Interview place: Jaunystės g. 1, Klaipėda

Interview length: 60 min.

Informant: 1

Position: Soldier of the Lithuanian National Defence Volunteer Forces.

1. What does the concept of having a public spirit mean to you?

For me, it is dedicating my time to serve in the Lithuanian Armed Forces or taking an active part in public activities that aim for a noble goal or benefit to the society. It is also related to performing my duties, for example, voting or celebrating national dates, such as the Independence Day.

2. How do you recognise people with high public spirit?

First of all, I believe, they adhere to high moral standards and are capable of critical thinking in the hardest of times. These people perform their constitutional duties, go to vote, pay taxes, and contribute to important decision-making.

3. Do you see yourself as someone with a high public spirit? Support your opinion.

Yes, I am, because I really care about...

4.

Sample table of categories, subcategories and supporting statements.

Table 1. Definition of high public spirit (table of categories, subcategories that confirm the statement)

Categories	Subcategories	Supporting statements
The concept and understanding of a high public spirit	Dedicating one's time	D.1 'dedicating one's precious time <...> so that they're better.'; 'I serve in the Lithuanian Armed Forces <...> contribute to some noble cause'. D4 'active participation in public activities'.
	Performance of one's duties	D5 'performing one's duties to the state and nation'. D2 'performing one's duties to the state and the society <...>'. D4 'public spirit refers to our duty to contribute to the improvement of the life of our state.' D3 '<...> votes in the elections for the parliament, president, or so, and is interested in the matters of the state'. D3 '<...> go to vote, a duty to do something good to the state'.
	Volunteering	D7 'Participating in volunteering organisations'. D6 '<...> volunteering and doing a military service'. D8 '<...> volunteering with no personal benefit <...>'. D5 '<...> volunteering for something good and helping someone'. D4 '<...> public spirit, <...> but also about the military service'.
	Using national insignia (the flag, the national anthem, national ornaments)	D1 'Monday-morning flag raising and national anthem'. D2 'Public spirit refers to knowing your country's history and traditions <...>'. D3 'That's respect to the state'. D5 'Cherishing your traditions'. D4 'Raising flags on the Independence Day is also public spirit'.
	Activity with no personal gain	D3 'activity that does not require funds, <...> you don't expect anything in return'. D4 'you do something <...> without asking some benefit in return'. D8 'That's being selfless, help, support to those, who need it'. D1 'assuming responsibility of taking care of the future of the community, the organisation, helping others, wanting to help'. D7 'For me personally, public spirit refers to some non-profit activity, where you can join this activity yourself'.
	Communication between people	D6 '<...> communication between people: hello, how are you, thank you'.
	Representing your country	D3 'Representing and promoting your country'. D2 'Active participation in some activity, related to your country'. D4 'doing good for your country'.

Source: research data from the focus group discussion of the *Getting to Know Public Spirit* project, 2021.

Sample observation protocol

OBSERVATION PROTOCOL NO. 1

Date:
Observation length:
Institution:
Class:
Children's age: 6-7 years
Application topic:
Goal:
Measures used for the work:
Short description of the activity:

Aspects of developing mathematical imagery	Pupils									
	B1	D1	N1	N2	R1	B1	S1	E1	F1	Pupils' body language, verbal statements, behaviour
Understanding shape										
Recognise and select objects in shape.										
Differentiate...										
....										
Understanding numbers										
Understand...										
Count...										
Can...										
...understanding										

Conventional signs for observations:

✓ – performs....

● –

....



FACULTY TITLE

DEPARTMENT TITLE

STUDY PROGRAMME TITLE

COMMENT OF THE GRADUATION PAPER ADVISOR

..... 20....

Klaipėda

Student(s)
Graduation paper/final project
topic:

No.	Criteria	Notes
1.	Relevance of the topic, reasoning and practical significance of the GP/project	
2.	Relations between the GP/project topic, aim, research object, methods applied and conclusions made	
3.	Theoretical part: the ability to analyse and systematise material	
4.	Validity of GP/project results, conclusions and recommendations	
5.	Novelty, variety, etc. of the literature and other information resources used	
6.	GP/project structure, volume, formatting and language use	
7.	GP/project advantages and disadvantages	
6.	Consistency, independence, and adherence to established schedule of the GP/project writing	

Conclusion on the compliance of the graduation paper with methodological requirements and proposal for a permission to defend the graduation paper at a public meeting of the qualification commission:

Graduation paper advisor:

(position)

(signature)

(name, surname)

REVIEW OF THE GRADUATION PAPER

..... 20....

Klaipėda

Student

Graduation paper/final project topic:

Study programme

No.	Criteria	Notes
1.	Relevance of the topic, reasoning and practical significance of the GP/project	
2.	Precision and purpose in formulating the research parameters (problem, object, aim and tasks)	
3.	Theoretical part: the ability to analyse and systematise material, appropriate choice of information resources	
4.	Clarity and reasoning of the description of the research methods	
5.	Analysis of the research results	
6.	Compliance of the conclusions to the tasks and results, reasoning of the recommendations	
7.	Compliance of the structure, volume, and formatting to methodological requirements and language use	
8.	GP/project advantages and disadvantages	
9.	Questions to the author of the graduation paper	

Conclusion on the compliance of the final thesis with methodological requirements and evaluation grade

(10 – excellent, 9 – very good, 8 – good, 7 – average, 6 – satisfactory, 5 – poor, 4, 3, 2, 1 – unsatisfactory)

Reviewer:

(Company, organisation, position)

(signature)

(name, surname)

COMMENT ON A COMMISSIONED GRADUATION PAPER

..... 20....

Klaipėda

Student:

Graduation paper/final project topic:

Study programme:

No.	Recommendations in the graduation paper	Are there any plans to apply the recommendations in the improvement of the organisation's operations (yes/no)
1.		
2.		
3.		
4.		
5.		

Conclusion on the commissioned graduation
paper: _____

Representative of the organisation

(organisation, position)

(signature)

(name, surname)

[illegible]

4. CP practical part evaluation (leave empty if the course paper focuses on theory).										
☐ The exploratory nature of the practical research part (i.e. it is not limited to the description of the research object, but contains elements necessary for analytical work – problem analysis, assessments, conclusions, proposals and their argumentation). ☐ This section is created by summarizing the most important results of the empirical study. ☐ The analysis is sufficiently deep, the conclusions and suggestions have practical significance.										
Evaluation:										
Total evaluation: If even one of the four aspects receive fewer than 5 points, the course paper is not evaluated. The overall result of the course paper is determined by the scores for parts 3 and 4.										

Other comments:

Course paper advisor:

(position)

(signature)

(name, surname)